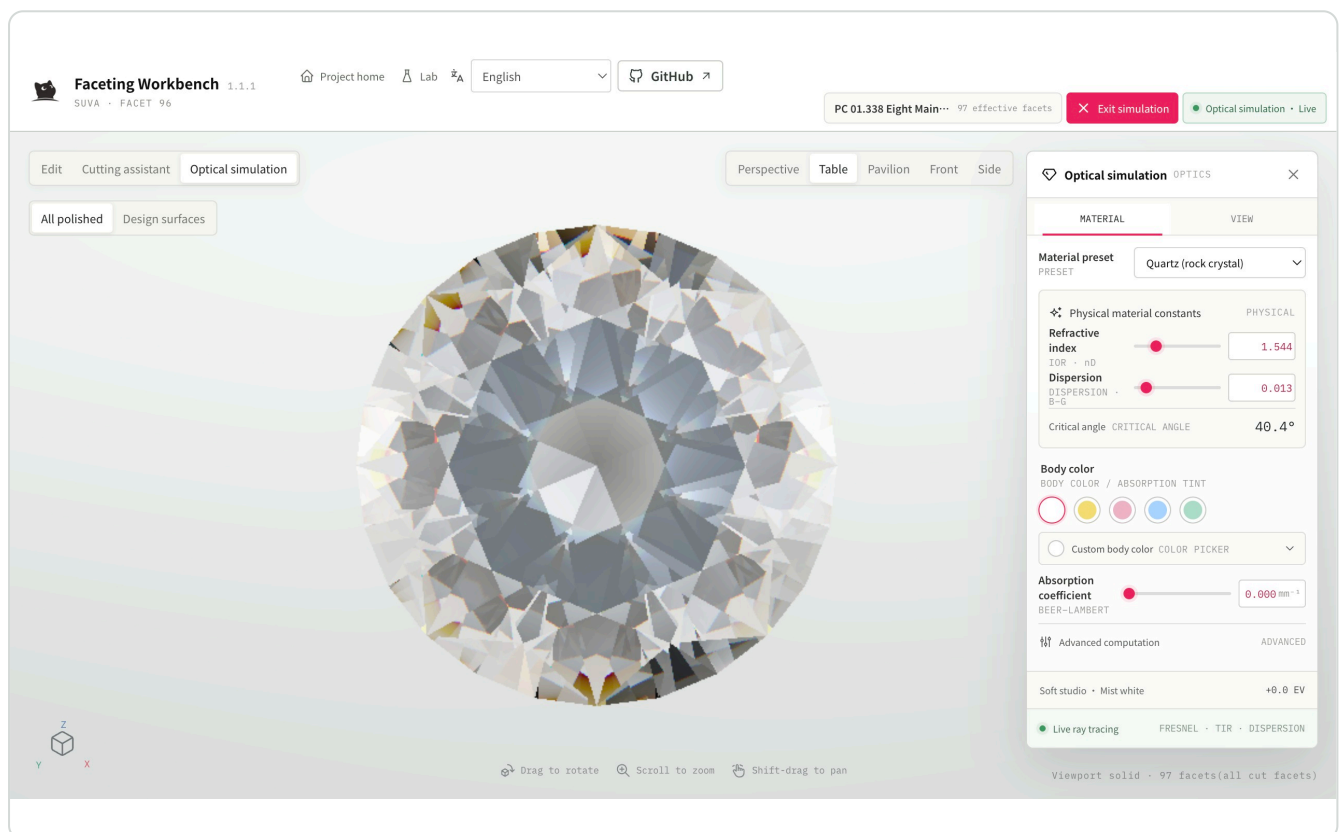




Designer's illustrated manual

From an idea to a gem of your own

Start with outline and proportion, arrange facets into a rhythm, then compare materials and lighting. Give every action a visible design purpose.



Eight Main Highlight · Actual quartz-material view of preset PC 01.338; this is not a prediction of physical fire or a machining guarantee.

Who this manual is for

For designers who adjust cuts, compare alternatives and communicate with faceters. No engineering vocabulary is required: each example starts with the shape you want to achieve.

Getting started

Prepare the exercises in docs/manual/examples and open the workbench version printed in the footer. Start with the project home on page 3, then enter the workbench using the exercise on page 4.

Reading route

Find the design question you are working on

On your first visit, follow Start → Compare → Position → Deliver. Later, jump directly to the page that matches your design goal.

03–07 Establish your starting point

Project home, exercise files, presets, three-panel workspace and live previews

08–10 Refine the proportions

Edit controls, angle and depth, and group transforms

11–15 Make facets meet where you want

Jump, single-point Meet, edge ratios and dual Meet

16–17 Use repetition to shape the composition

Custom primary facet, repeats, mirrors and preform intent

18–20 Continue after changing earlier cuts

Repair references, inspect stages and replay cutting step by step

21–23 Compare material and light distribution

Lab entry, optical simulation, viewpoints and comparison methods

24–26 Hand the design to your next collaborator

Files, local projects, shortcuts and delivery notes

27–28 Start with concave rough

OBJ crystal preflight, orientation, zero CUTs and shaped blanks

29–30 Build and refine through conversation

Reference studies, connected workbench, real previews, saving and reopening

31–33 Work with indexing, stock and concave cuts independently

Index compatibility, fivefold concave cuts, independent parameter groups and restoring covered facets

START · PROJECT HOME

Find the project you want to continue

The workbench opens at project home. Treat each project as an evolving design: name its purpose and use the actual outline on its card to recognize it.



Your first visit includes two real cuts. New project and saved projects share a left-to-right grid, with each new row starting at the left edge; All expands the rest, and search shows every match.

1

Create a starting point

Click New project, choose the equipment wheel, then select the default shape, a stock preset or an OBJ. The default includes a table and whole-tooth girdle; shaped stock starts without cuts.

2

Continue a design

Search by name and open its card. Reopening a project saves to the same card, without making a copy. Rename the design at the top of the editor.

3

Keep your current experiment

Returning home leaves the current CUT intact. “Resume design” restores that workspace; switching or creating a project asks about any unsaved preview.

Pause and make a design judgment

Can you recognize the design by its name and outline? If not, give it a short name that expresses the design goal.

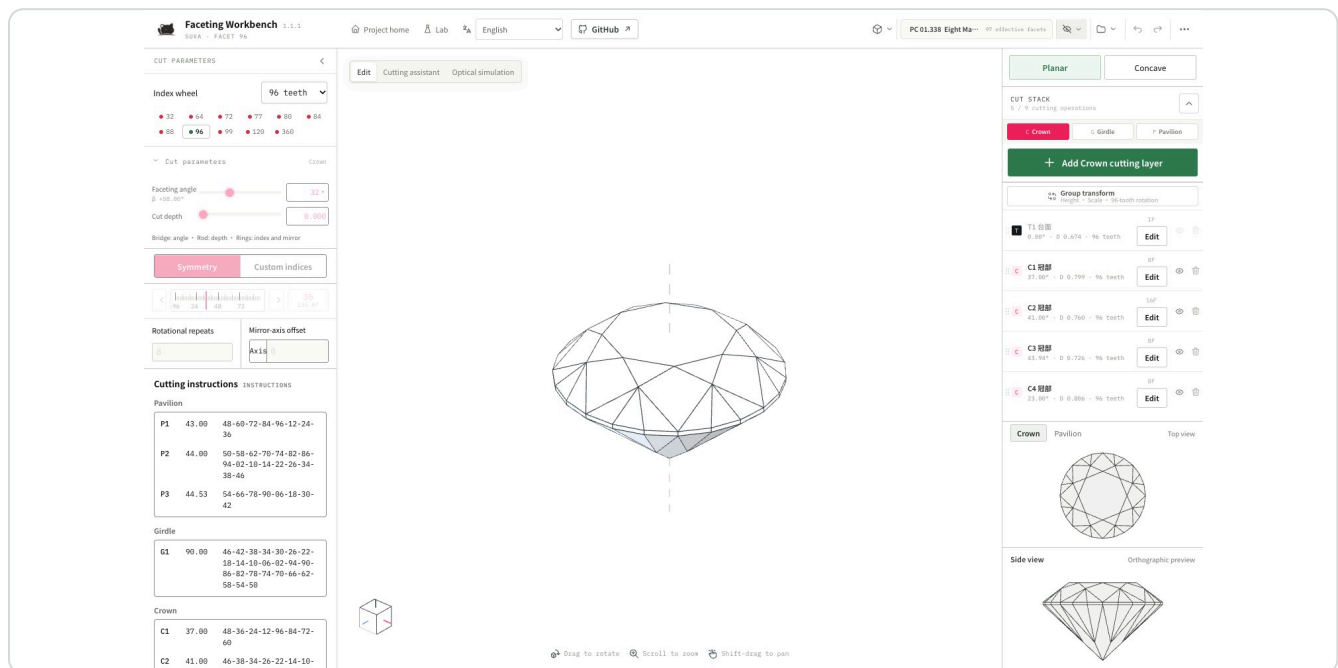
Before you continue

Committed cuts and material save automatically. Cards exclude unsaved previews; reloading does not restore drafts or old undo history. The card’s upper-left delete control requires confirmation and cannot be undone. Export important designs as JSON.

PREPARE · EXERCISE FILES

Choose a starting point that reveals the question

Use Eight Main Highlight from the preset library for finished-cut observation. Cutting and Meet exercises use a simplified round built in stages, making new intersections easy to see. Exercises are not recommended finished cuts or production recipes.



Finished example: PC 01.338 Eight Main Highlight, 97 effective facets, designed by Long, R H & Steele, N W. On the home page choose New project → Start from a preset cut and search for its name.

Open the exercise

Enter the workbench, then choose File → Import JSON and select 01-round-start.json. It opens as a separate project, retaining the original. An unsaved preview requires confirmation before switching. Rename it, for example Round_Facet_Study_01, and export JSON.

Write one design goal

For example: “Keep the round outline and add a light decorative rhythm to the crown.” Judge each later change against this sentence.

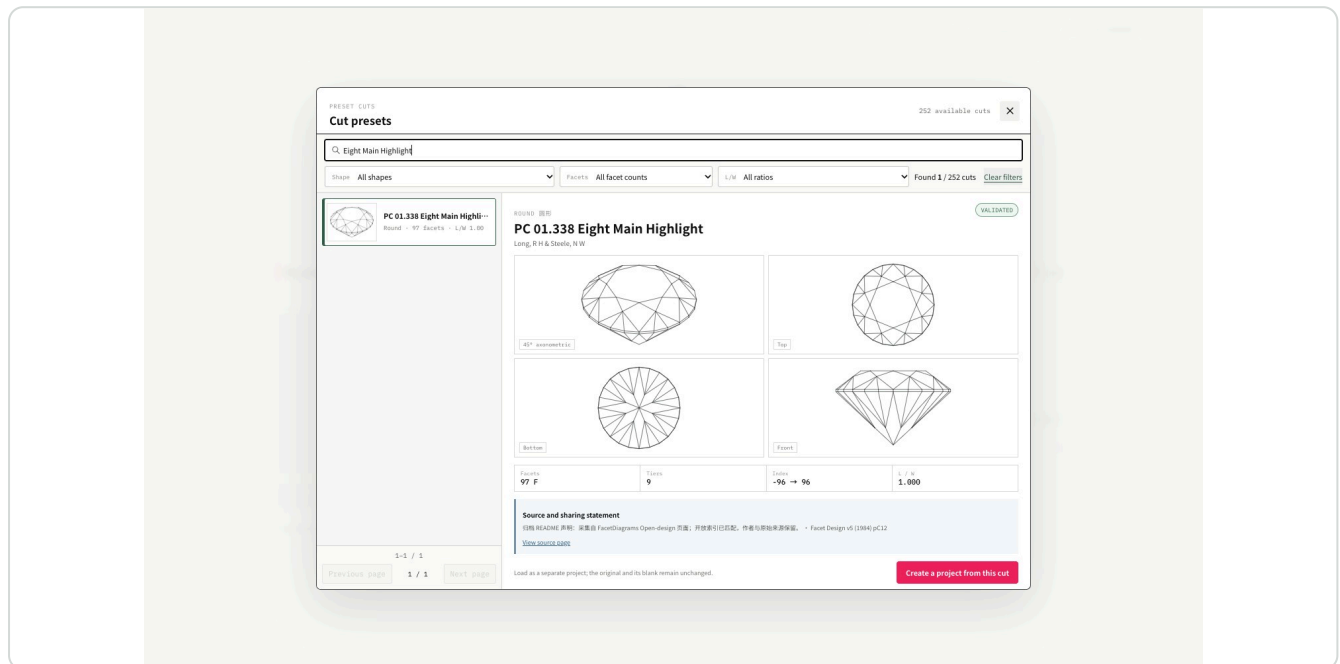
Exercise and comparison files

02 / 03 compare two ratios on the same edge; 04 uses two points; 05 lowers the crown; 06 adds four-direction decoration; 07 needs repair. File numbers identify alternatives, not a required cutting sequence.

START · CHOOSE A CUT

Start with an outline in the preset library

If you already want a cushion, oval or emerald shape, find a similar outline in the library. Treat the preset as a study: retain its author and source, and save your own variation separately.



Actual preset library: compare all four views to avoid perspective distortion.

1 Open candidates

Home → New project → Start from a preset cut. Combine outline, effective facet count and L/W filters; search names, authors or sources with multiple keywords. Each page shows 60 cuts.

2 Look from four directions

Top shows outline and table; front shows crown height and pavilion depth; bottom shows pavilion structure; axonometric shows the whole shape.

3 Load and name

Choose Create project from this cut, then rename your design and export a JSON copy as the starting version. Your original project stays on the home page. Filters and pagination do not change it.

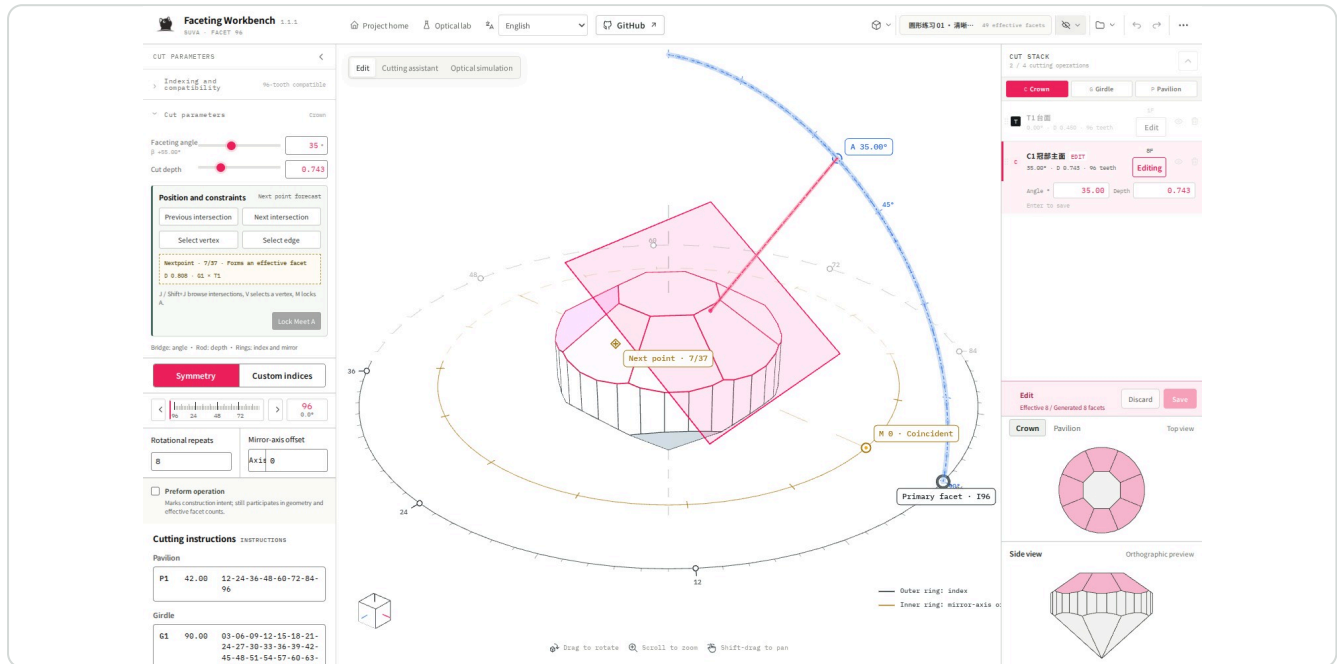
Pause and make a design judgment

Does the outline suit the intended setting? Does the table size suit the shape's character? Describe any remaining concern as one concrete change.

START · WORKSPACE MAP

Find your next action in the workbench

Inspect the 3D shape in the center, adjust the current cut on the left, and review steps and two live views on the right. Each CUT STACK row is a group of facets edited together.



After clicking Edit on C1: the parameter panel, primary cutting plane and pink editing bar appear together.

Left: adjust the current facets

Faceting angle controls tilt, depth controls advance, and index controls direction. Repeats and mirrors arrange facets around the stone.

Upper right: steps and saving

Use C Crown, G Girdle and P Pavilion to filter the list; scroll for more cuts. Click Edit on a row. The green New control below the region tabs becomes the new-cut status bar. Save / Discard appear in the edited row.

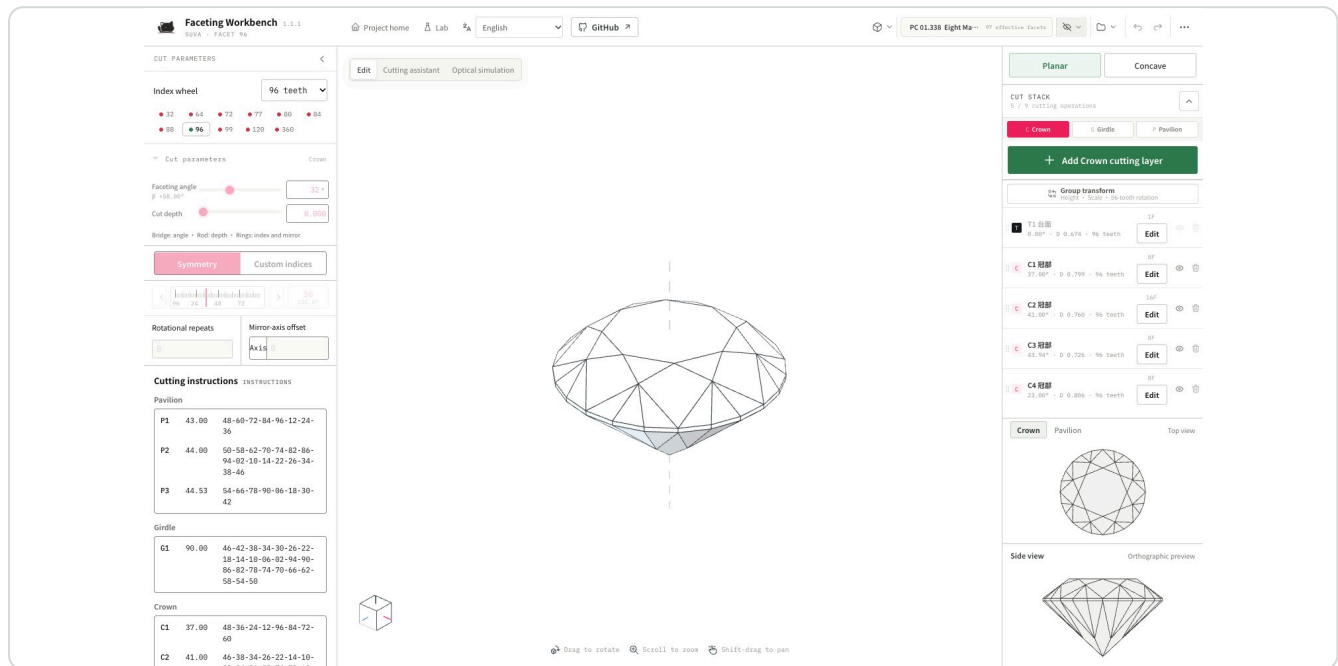
Top and canvas: inspect and manage

The top bar provides project home, lab, views, display, files and undo. The canvas mode switch selects Edit, Cutting assistant or Optical simulation. Drag to rotate, scroll to zoom, Shift-drag to pan. GitHub remains available in every mode and opens in a new tab.

OBSERVE · LIVE SIDE PREVIEWS

Check crown, pavilion and profile as you work

Judge facet rhythm and overall height together. Two orthographic windows follow the current shape while keeping fixed viewing directions as you rotate the central 3D view.



The upper window switches between crown/top and pavilion/bottom; the lower window stays in side view. Helpers are hidden so the actual intersections remain clear.

- 1 Fix a starting point**
Load Eight Main Highlight and edit C1 Crown. Adjust depth slightly and watch the central and side views update together.
- 2 Compare facet groups**
Choose Crown in the upper window to inspect facets around the table, or Pavilion for bottom intersections. This affects only that window, without rotating the central stone or changing cuts.
- 3 Compare proportions**
Use the lower window to compare crown height, girdle and pavilion depth. Check table position, outline continuity and new small facets. Save in CUT STACK if satisfied; otherwise discard.

Pause and make a design judgment

At the same viewing angle, does the added facet group make the rhythm clearer? Does the profile still match your design goal?

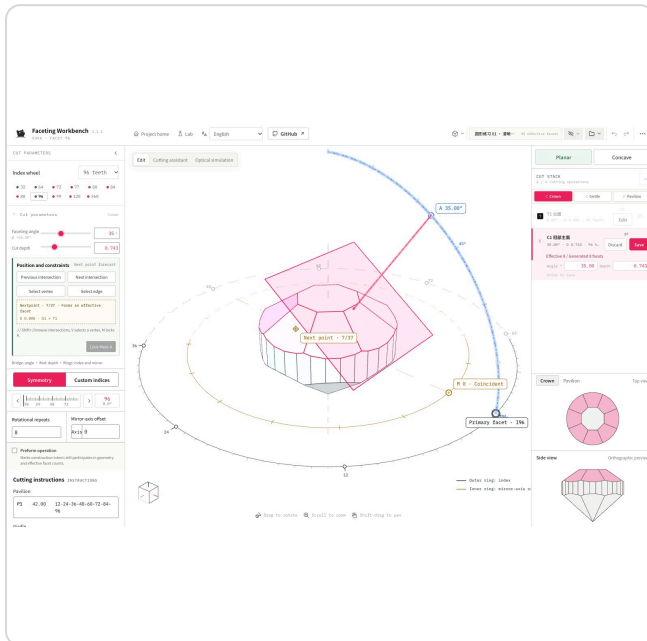
Before you continue

Side windows are live, read-only views: pale blue marks a new preview and pale pink the edited tier. Unsaved shapes can be compared but are excluded from projects and exports.

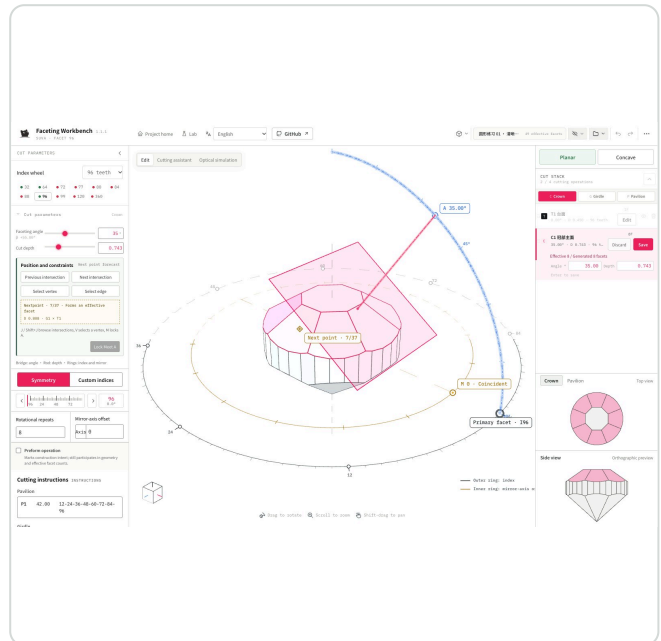
BASICS · EDIT AND SAVE

To change a facet group, click Edit

Every editable tier has a visible Edit control. The selected row says Editing. Clicking the name still renames the tier.



Tier list · Editing C1



Bottom of list · Discard or save

C1 is being edited. Discard and Save are in the current layer row.

1

Enter

Find C1 Crown mains in the C Crown list and click Edit. The initial view matches the saved shape.

2

Try

Increase the angle slightly and use front view to inspect the tilt. Pink indicates the current edit, not the final material.

3

Decide

Save the change if it works, or discard to retain the original. Saving returns to idle; Undo restores the previous step.

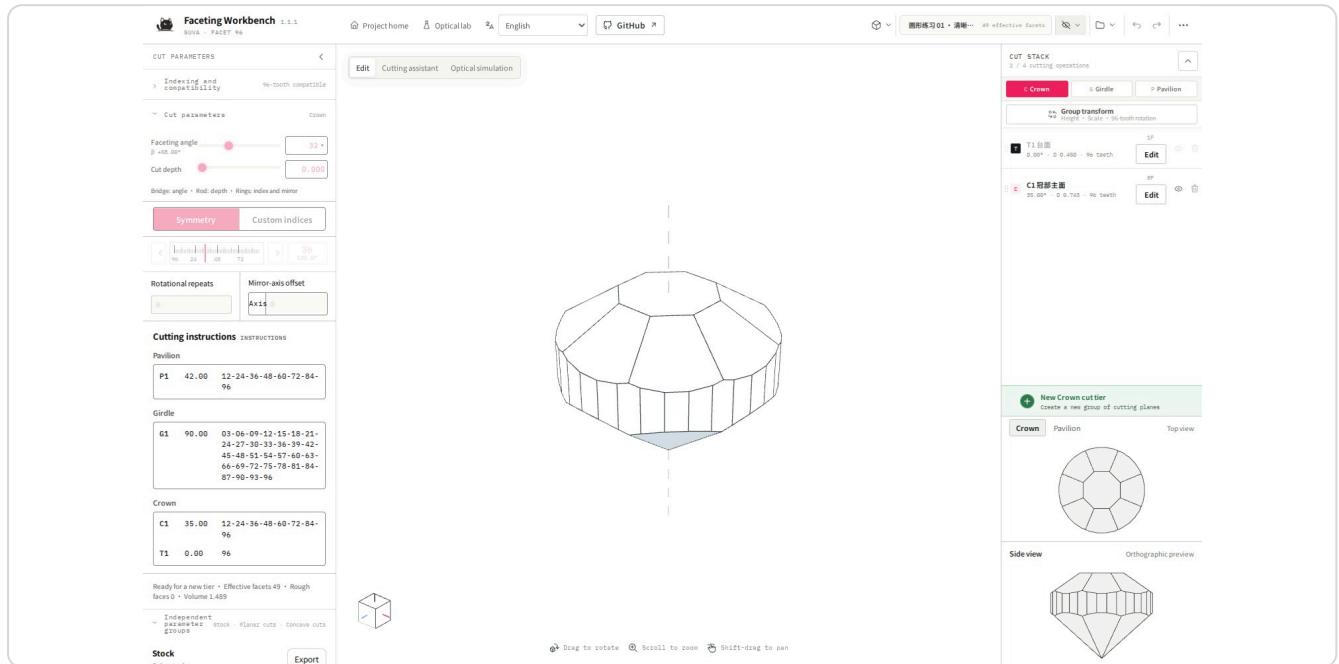
Pause and make a design judgment

Can you immediately tell which facets you are editing? Does the change support your stated goal? Being able to click Save is not the design outcome.

BASICS · WHAT THE PARAMETERS DO

Explore angle, depth and direction in small steps

Change one relationship at a time so you can identify its effect. Look at geometry before material. Blue new-cut previews and pink edit highlights are interaction feedback only.



The helper and primary plane show the direction of a new CUT. Actual facets are determined by intersections with the solid.

Angle: change the tilt

Crown and pavilion angles adjust in 0.01° steps. The table stays at 0° , the girdle at 90° . Single Meet allows angle changes; dual Meet determines the angle from two points.

Depth: decide how far to advance

Advancing the cutting plane along its normal changes intersections with neighboring facets. Enter exact values when needed. The handle endpoint is not a gemstone vertex.

Index: turn the facet group

The default wheel has 96 teeth. Choose another in Indexing and compatibility; the last tooth and 0 share a direction. Click the readout to enter fractions; dragging snaps to whole teeth. The gizmo follows the selected primary facet.

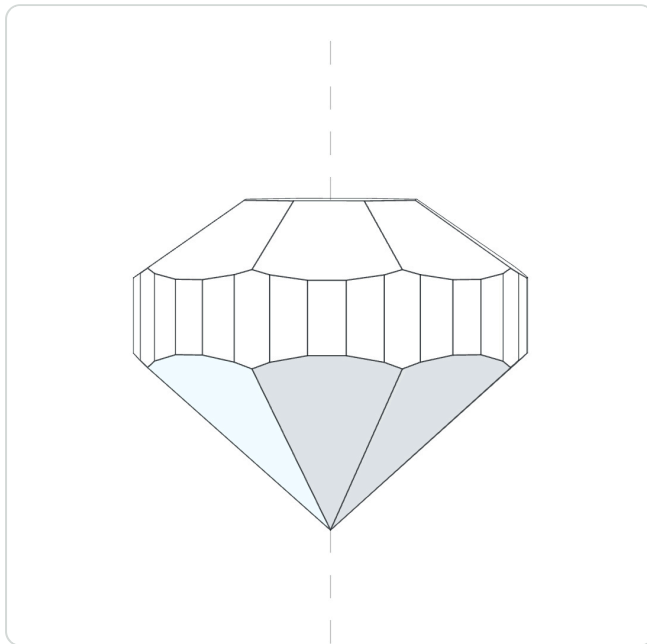
Why saving may be unavailable

A new cut needs a valid geometric result. It may completely cover an earlier facet; the earlier operation remains recoverable. Adjust or cancel if the cut removes all stock, makes no effective cut, or cannot satisfy its constraints.

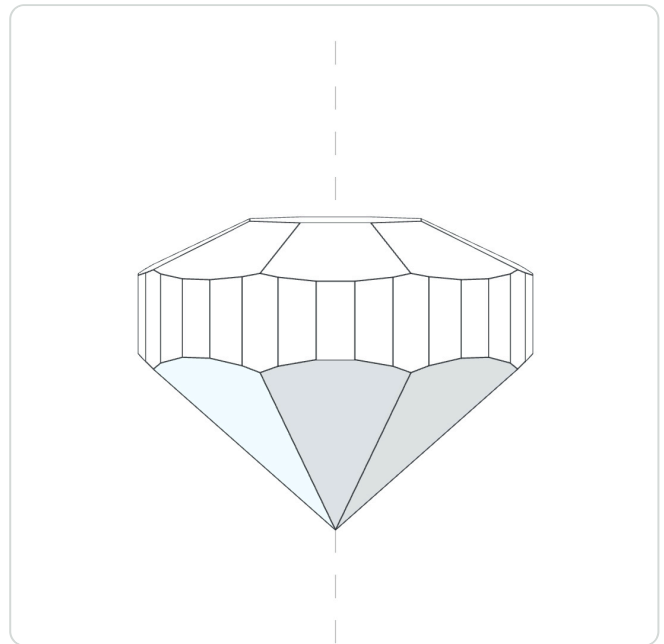
EXAMPLE A · OVERALL PROPORTIONS

Compare a tall crown with a lower crown

Goal: keep the round outline and see whether a lower crown suits your setting height or style. The group transform includes the table, helping retain continuity between tiers.



Original · Height 100%



Lower crown · Height 70%

Compare from the same front view. Only crown height changes; the pavilion stays unchanged.

1

Open the original

Import 01-round-start.json and click Group transform in the crown list.

2

Try 70%

Set height scale to 70%, leaving translation and rotation at 0. Inspect front and side views, then save. Import 05-low-crown.json to compare the result.

3

Judge, rather than copy

Check the table-to-crown transition and whether the height suits your design. 70% is a comparison condition, not a universal optimum.

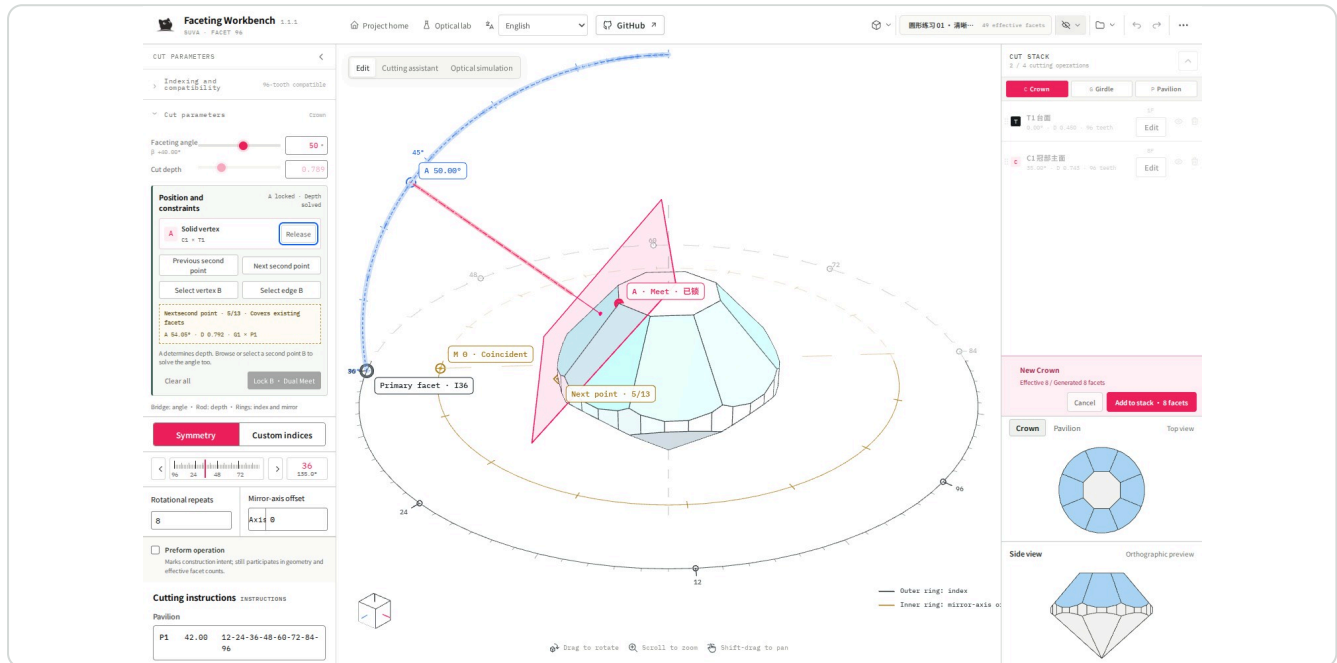
Before you continue

Group transforms combine translation and index rotation. The crown includes the table; the pavilion is separate. Height follows the planar outline; concave tools and the blank stay fixed, and the viewport shows the combined result. Existing Meets may need review after a source tier changes.

EXAMPLE B · JUMP AND SINGLE MEET

Pass the primary plane through an existing intersection

Goal: meet an existing structure precisely. Jump browses candidate positions; Meet remembers a chosen position as a constraint.



After locking A, the target point determines depth; faceting angle remains adjustable.

1 Find a position

Create a crown cut and use Next / Previous intersection, or Select vertex and pick a point on the solid. Check that the highlighted sources are the intended intersection.

2 Lock A

Click Lock Meet A after inspecting the preview. When you change angle, depth adjusts to keep the primary plane passing through A.

3 Check the whole ring

Repeated facets cut together, but the constraint applies to the primary facet. Rotate the stone and check other directions before adding the cut.

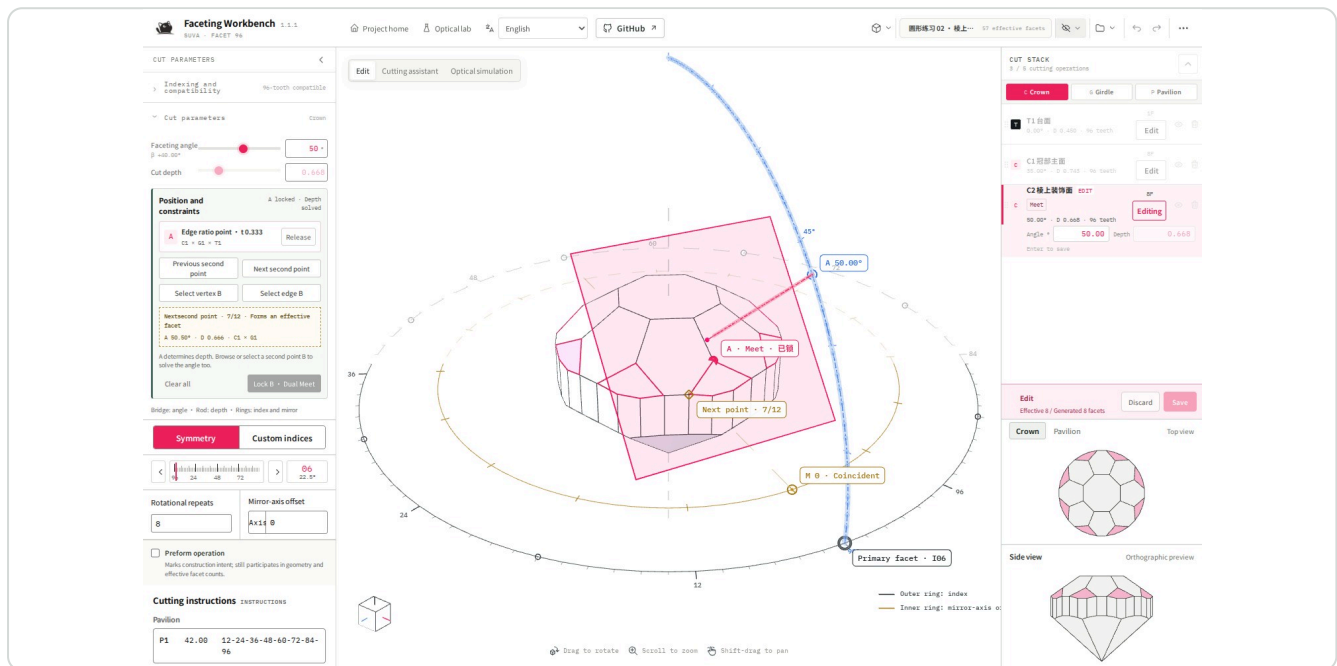
Before you continue

This example adds a single-point crown cut to the round exercise. Later edge examples use the same starting point. Girdle and fixed table cuts do not support Meet / Jump.

EXAMPLE C · EDGE RATIO

Choose where decoration starts on an existing edge

Goal: add small facets between eight crown mains, turning sharp ridges into a decorative band of varying width. An edge ratio gives you a repeatable position to compare.



Variant 02: primary I6, 8 repeats, 50°, passing through one third of the sloping edge between C1's I96 and I12 facets.

1 Identify the edge

Import 02-edge-third.json and edit C2. The A source description and canvas marker identify the sloping edge, not a horizontal table edge.

2 Try from the beginning

Import 01, add a crown cut, and set index 6, repeat 8 and angle 50°. Select the sloping edge, set its ratio to 1/3, then lock A.

3 Check the target position

Here the stable edge direction runs from girdle toward table, so 1/3 is nearer the girdle. For another edge, temporarily try $t = 0$ and 1 to identify its ends. Do not assume every edge runs upward.

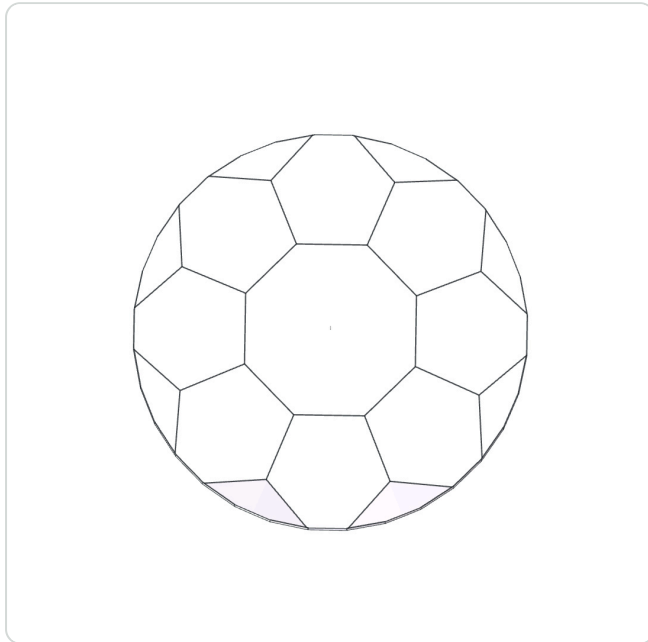
Before you continue

An edge Meet passes the plane through one point on an edge; it does not place the whole edge in the plane. If you chose the wrong edge, select the correct source instead of compensating with depth.

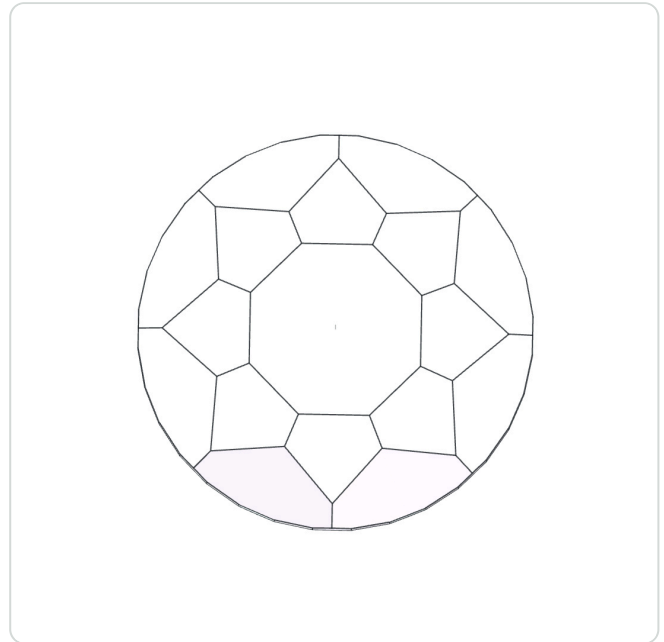
EXAMPLE C · COMPARE SHAPES

One edge, two ratios, two rhythms

Keep 50°, I6 and 8 repeats unchanged; move A from 1/3 to 2/3 of the same edge. This isolates how much crown area the decoration occupies.



1/3 · Variant 02



2/3 · Variant 03

Both files retain 57 effective facets. Equal facet counts do not imply equal facet widths or equal space around the table.

Workflow

Import 02, edit C2, release A, then select the same sloping edge at 2/3. Lock Meet A and save. You can also import 03 directly. A locked Meet is not adjusted by freely dragging depth.

Observe three relationships

Look at the new facet tips near the table, the remaining crown-main area and the eightfold rhythm in top view. Check axonometric view to rule out a viewpoint illusion.

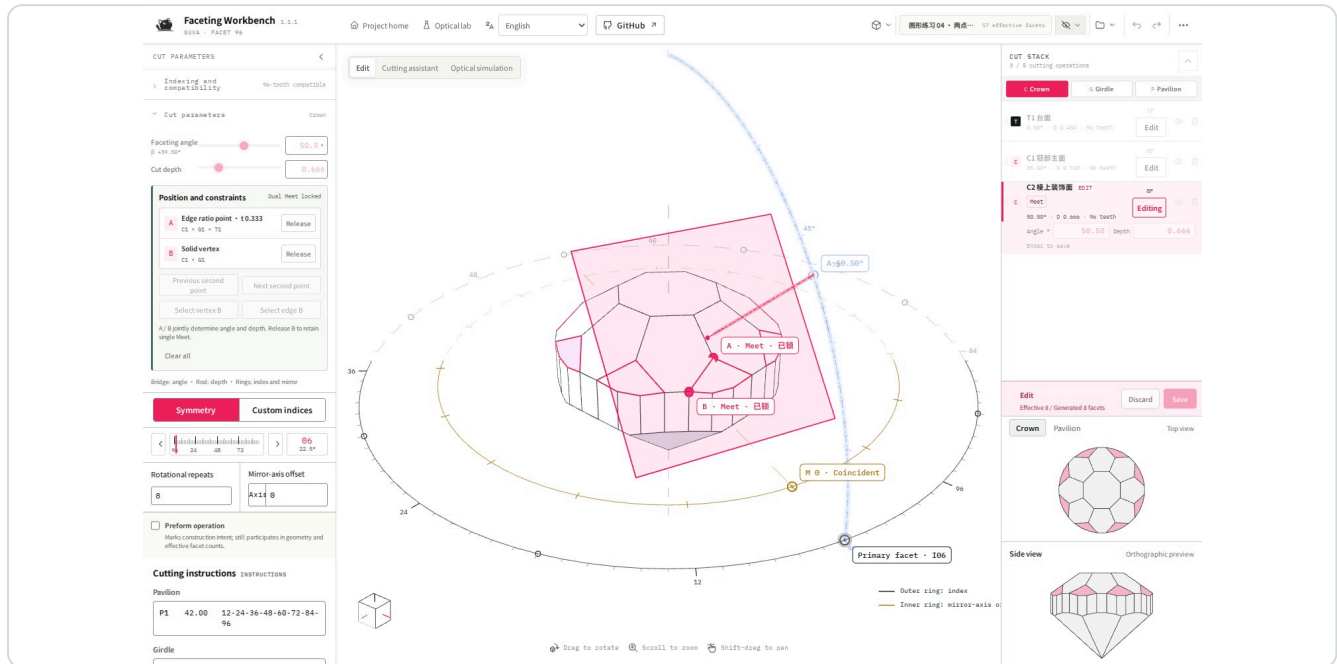
Let the designer decide

Do you want broader crown mains or more subdivision? Write a reason to use each alternative before choosing. This manual does not declare one more beautiful.

EXAMPLE D · DUAL MEET

Use a second point to determine tilt

Goal: satisfy two meeting relationships at once. With a fixed primary index, two distinct points can determine the plane's tilt and position together.



Variant 04: A is at one third of the sloping edge, B an existing vertex. The solved angle is about 50.50°; depth is solved with it.

1

Inspect A and B

Import 04-dual-meet.json and edit C2. Inspect both markers and sources to understand which intersections they preserve.

2

Try a second point

Starting with A locked, browse Next / Previous second point or select a second vertex or edge point. Inspect the candidate, then click Lock B · Dual Meet.

3

Inspect the result

Angle and depth becoming read-only is expected. Use top and axonometric views to judge whether meeting both points is worth changing your preferred tilt.

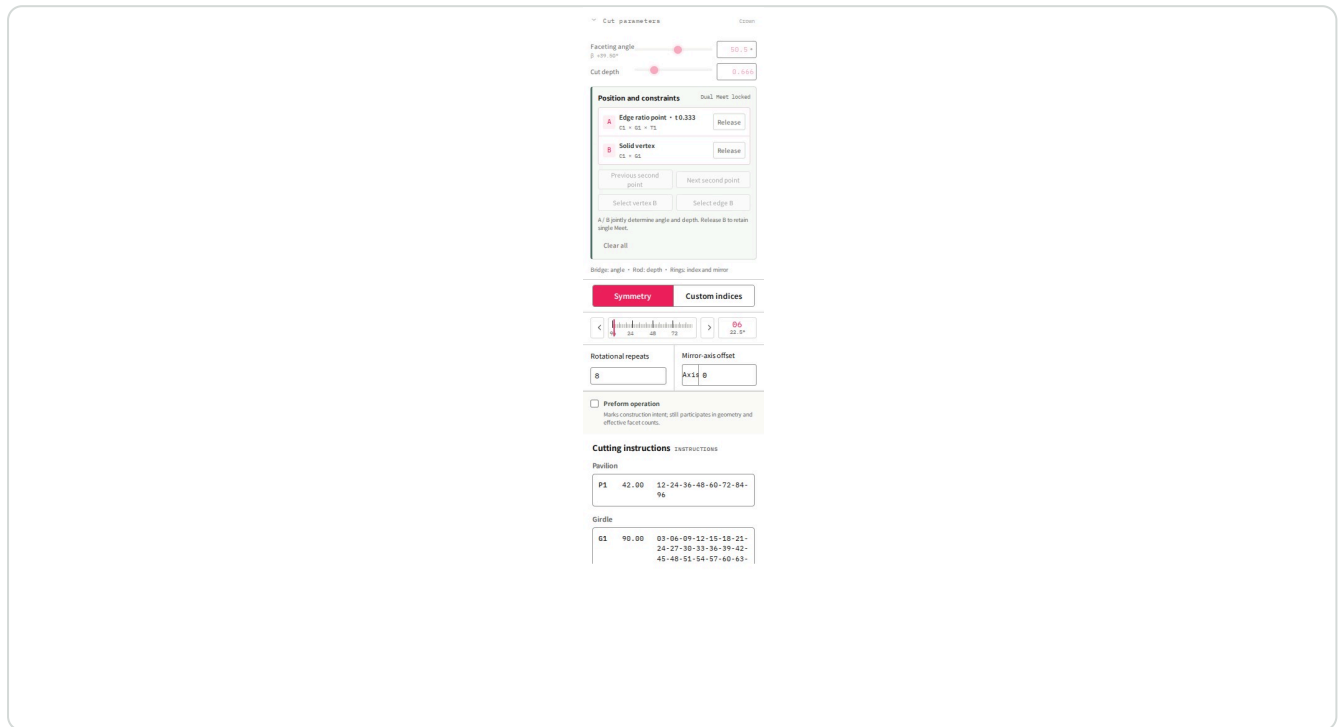
Before you continue

A suitable second-point solution may not exist. Selecting two points does not make a design better by itself; dual Meet is a precision construction tool.

MEET · CANCEL AND RELEASE

Step back while keeping the choice you made

When exploring, know how to return. Distinguish browsing a second point from having both points locked.



A and B are shown separately so either source can be released. Locked parameters are visibly disabled.

B is still a preview

Canceling the second-point preview restores the original single-A angle and depth. You do not need to remember or re-enter them.

B is locked

Release B to retain A and adjust angle again. Release A to promote B to A. Clear all to restore free angle and depth.

When no solution is available

If points coincide, the direction is unsuitable or the target is out of reach, change the point or primary index. The system does not silently choose another primary facet.

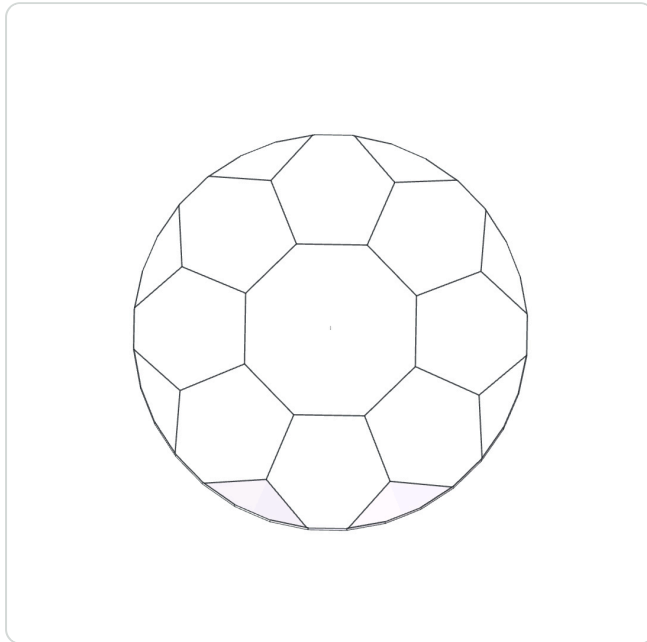
Escape order

Close the floating panel or current picking / ratio tool first, then leave the second-point preview, then cancel the CUT. Watch the state rather than pressing repeatedly.

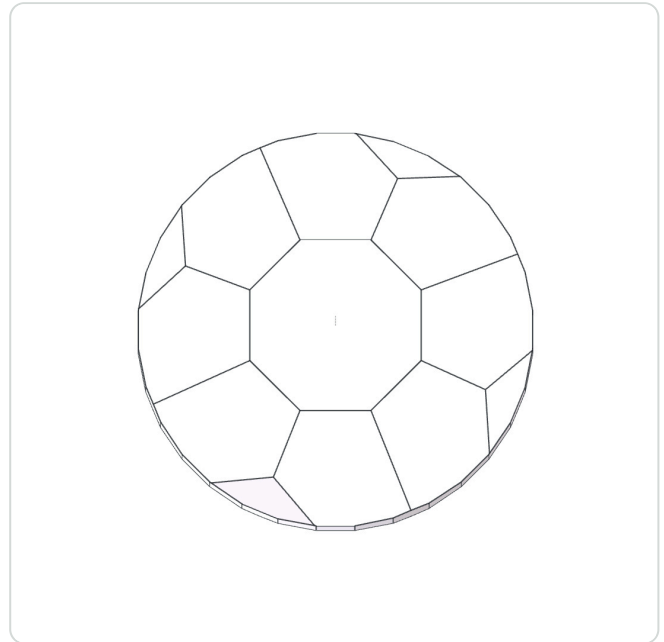
EXAMPLE E · CUSTOM RHYTHM

From eight repeats to four main directions

Goal: concentrate decoration in four directions to establish hierarchy. Custom indices specify where facets appear; the primary facet specifies the direction used for positioning.



Eight directions · 57 facets



Four directions · 53 facets

Variant 06 retains only I6, 30, 54 and 78. Removing four decorative facets changes the open areas; it does not remove all crown facets.

1

Specify the positions

Import 02-edge-third.json, edit C2, switch to Custom indices and enter 6, 30, 54, 78.

2

Choose the primary facet

Select 6 as the Primary facet index, then check the A Meet. The primary facet must belong to the set; it cannot be removed while a constraint uses it.

3

Compare the composition

Use top view to check whether the four directions suit your intended setting. Recheck the solid after rotating or changing the index set.

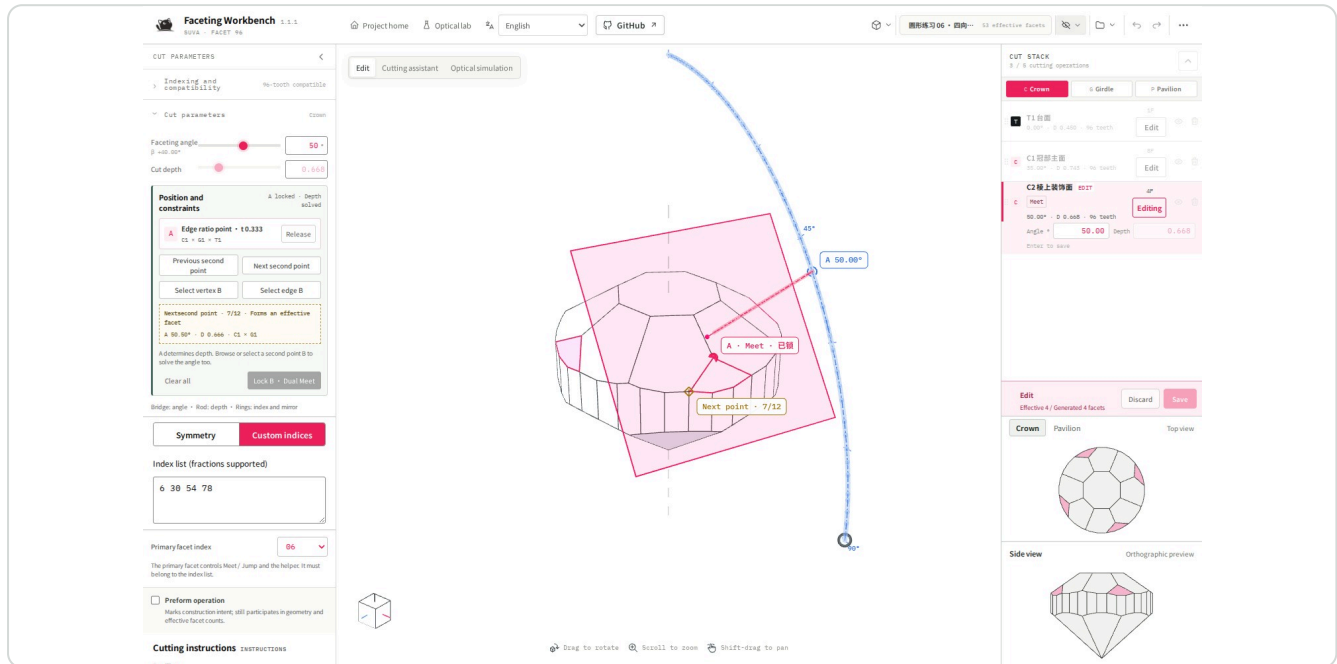
Before you continue

This example still has fourfold symmetry. Asymmetric sets are supported, but require facet-by-facet inspection; symmetry is not added automatically.

ORGANIZE · BEYOND FACET COUNT

Express intent with repeats, mirrors and preforms

A facet group may create rhythm or provide a source for a later cut. Meaningful step names make it easier to resume than remembering long parameter lists.



The helper and Meet / Jump follow the selected primary facet.

Repeat: one rule around the stone

8 repeats generate eight explicit planes. Later cuts may cover some earlier facets; the original operations remain available for undo and redo.

Mirror: add a second set of directions

Adjusting mirror-axis offset adds mirrored members; coincident planes are deduplicated. Observe the alternating rhythm in top view instead of maximizing facet count.

Preform: describe this step's purpose

Mark a normal crown or pavilion tier as a Preform operation when it prepares for later steps. This marker does not hide, delete or disable the cut.

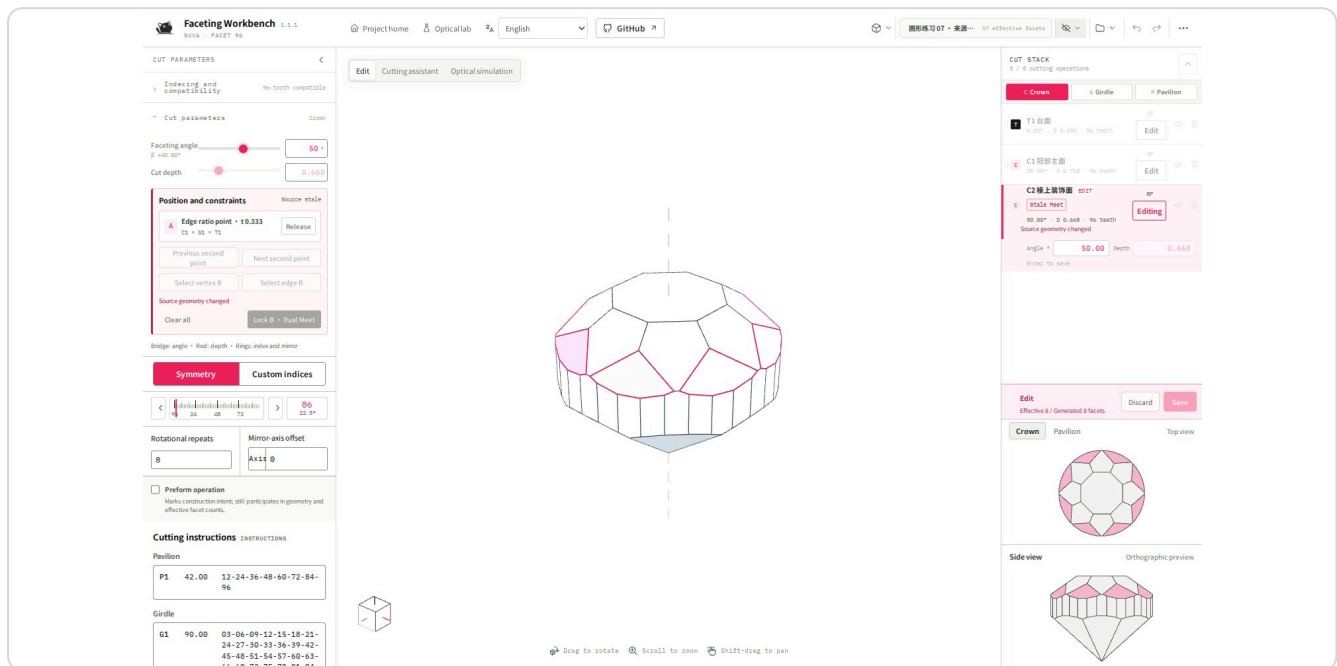
Name it for your next collaborator

Click a tier name to rename it, for example “Crown mains” or “Four-way decoration”. Toggle visibility to inspect effects; drag non-table tiers to reorder. These changes may invalidate later Meet sources.

EXAMPLE F · REPAIR REFERENCES

After changing an earlier shape, what happens to Meets?

Goal: retain saved cutting planes while identifying meeting relationships that need a new design decision. A stale source does not automatically recut the stone; the warning asks you to reconsider intent.



Variant 07: raising C1 Crown mains by 0.03 changes the source of C2's original edge point.

1 Read the warning

Import 07-source-changed.json and inspect C2's stale marker. Compare it with 02: which intersections no longer match your intent?

2 Select again

Edit C2, release the stale source, and select the required edge point or vertex on the solid before this cut. To retain the original intent, try one third of the same sloping edge.

3 Decide again

Inspect and save the new preview. If the Meet is no longer needed, clear the constraint and retain a free construction. Do not choose an arbitrary point just to remove the warning.

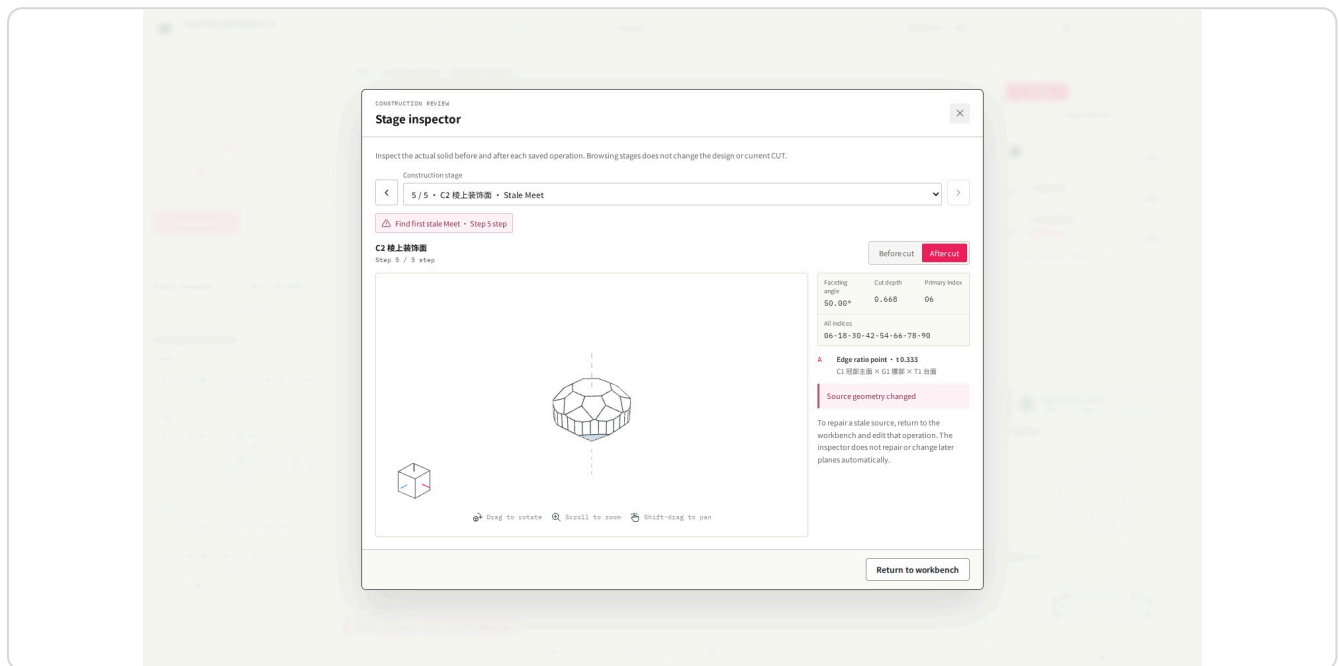
Before you continue

Hiding, deleting, reordering or editing a source can make it stale. Saved planes remain intact and a warning appears; downstream cuts are not all changed automatically.

DIAGNOSE · STAGE INSPECTOR

Inspect stages to understand how the shape changed

Goal: break the shape into understandable design steps. Use the inspector to review mains, decoration and source relationships, alone or with another designer.



The inspector pairs stage geometry with parameters and sources. This example focuses on C2's stale reference.

1

Open

More tools → Stage inspector. Select an operation or locate the first stale Meet.

2

Compare before and after

Switch Before cut / After cut to see what the step actually leaves. A hidden operation produces no difference.

3

Return with a question

The inspector is read-only and preserves your editing workspace. Close it and edit the relevant tier to repair the design.

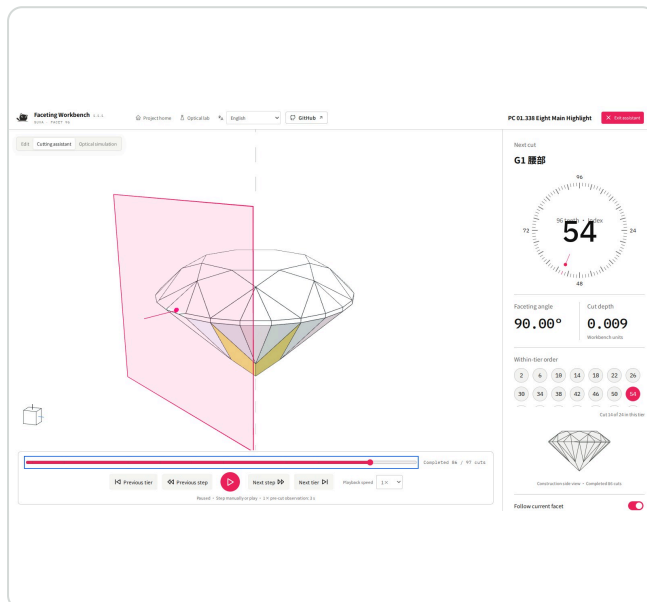
Pause and make a design judgment

Does this step add clear structure or unnecessary fragments? Does it still serve as a preform? Keeping or reverting it are both valid choices.

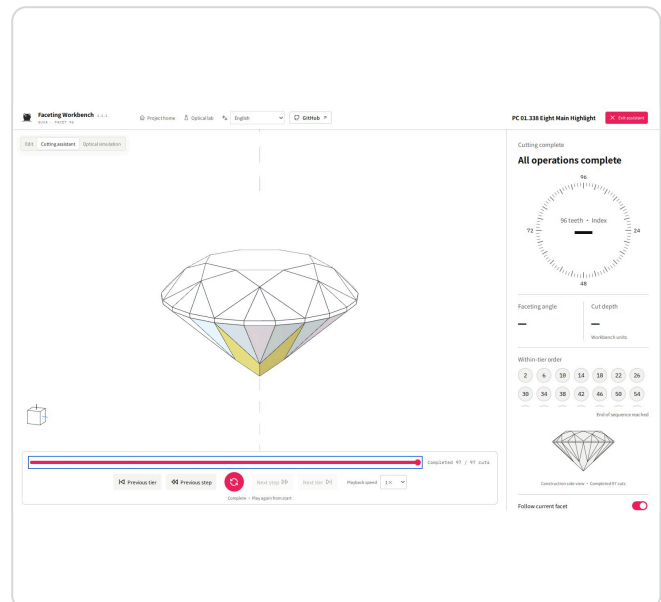
DEMONSTRATE · CUTTING ASSISTANT

Replay the actual cutting order before delivery

Check the intended cutting order or show a collaborator how the stone is built. The assistant replays the committed design from the rough, one cut at a time, in CUT STACK order.



86/97 cuts completed · Next cut and intermediate shape



Step 97/97 · Complete

Actual Eight Main Highlight replay: pink marks the next plane, while the intermediate solid shows completed cuts. The sequence uses committed CUT STACK only, excluding drafts.

1 Enter

Canvas mode switch → Cutting assistant. Start at step 0 with the rough. Hidden tiers do not cut; the fixed table is always one step.

2 Watch by cut or by tier

Use Next / Previous step on the bottom bar for individual cuts, or Next / Previous tier to jump groups. Play runs at 0.5× / 1× / 2×. Drag the timeline to seek; manual steps and backgrounding pause playback. The right panel shows the next index, angle, depth and within-tier order. Completed counts cuts already made. Frosted facets show “Frosted facet · Do not polish” without changing the cut count or parameters.

3 Return to editing

Click the pink Exit assistant button or press Escape to restore the previous workspace. The assistant is read-only and adds no history. After each cut, it holds 0.5 seconds, then eases to a 45° offset view; the next plane appears once settled. Adjust transition speed on the right. Dragging pauses following; the switch resumes it. Use Stage inspector for stale-source diagnosis.

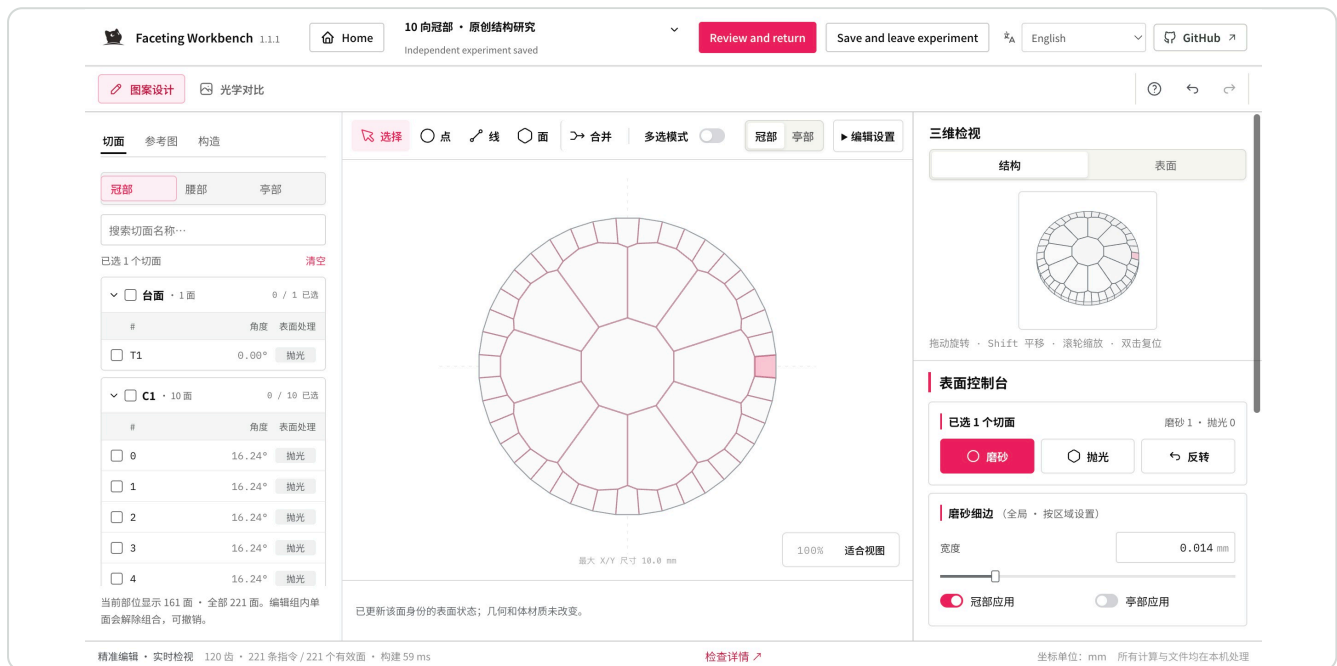
Pause and make a design judgment

Which facet group's ordering needs explanation to the faceter? Does the sequence express your intent, or should you revise CUT STACK?

NAVIGATE · LAB

Bring an experimental design back as a new version

Explore a pattern from an existing design or start a new experiment. Adjust facets, review the result, and bring it back as a separate project. Keep the original for comparison.



The workspace has one brand header. Select the experiment name to inspect its source version or download recovery data.

1 Enter with the current design

Save or discard pending CUTs first. Open Lab and select Use current design to retain a source snapshot. Alternatively, choose New experiment and select an index gear and width in millimeters.

2 Edit and review

Select facets by group or with multi-select, then use the Surface Console to frost, polish or invert them. Bevel width is shared; crown and pavilion have separate switches. Choose Check and bring back, review operations, active faces, scale and source status, then bring back as a new project. A changed source still uses the original snapshot.

3 Exit and recover

Save and leave experiment returns to the overview. Resume from Recent experiments. Select the experiment name to download recovery data. If saving fails, stay in the experiment and retry or download recovery data.

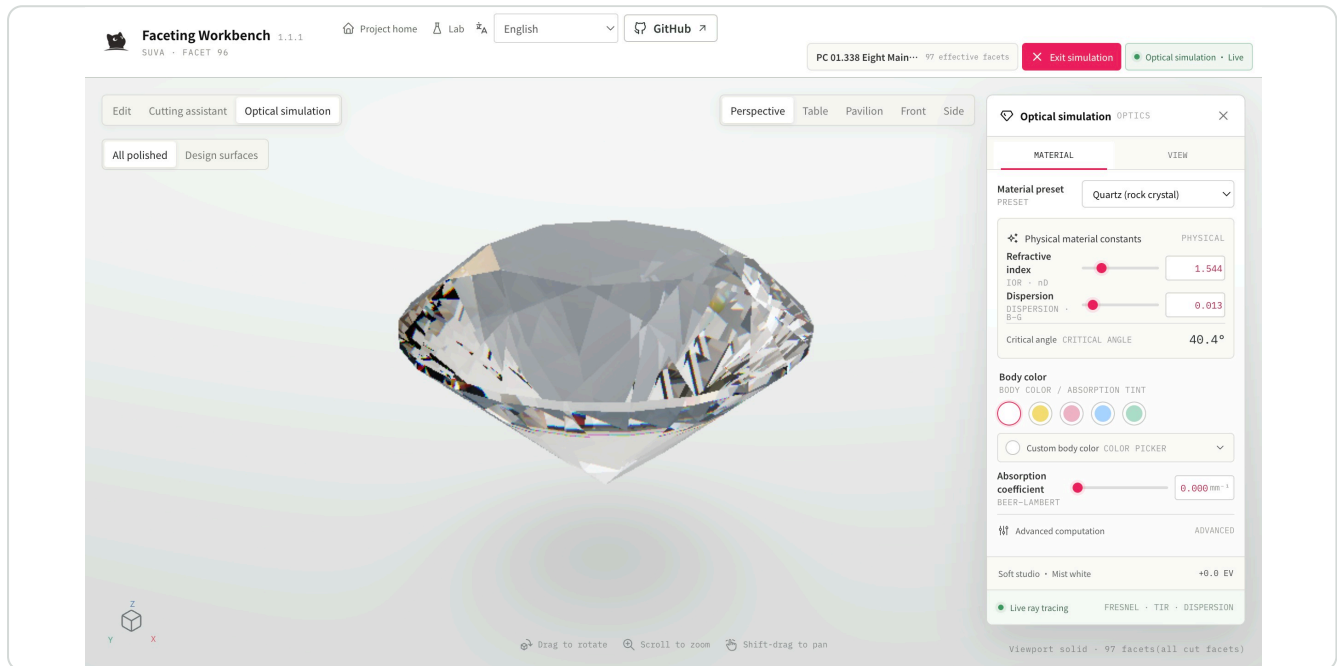
Before you continue

If physical scale is missing, click Calibrate size above the canvas and enter the measured width before moving points or generating frosted bevels. Do not guess dimensions. Stale recipes retain actual planes and are not replayed. Mesh and concave designs cannot be brought in yet.

OPTICS · OBSERVE DIFFERENCES

Fix viewing conditions before comparing materials

Once the geometry is clear, enter Optical simulation from the canvas mode switch or display menu. Editing tools hide so you can focus on material, light and outline. View changes ease to a stop; dragging takes control. Exiting restores the editing workspace. While dragging, a fast preview responds first; it becomes sharper when movement stops. Let the image settle before comparing details.



Use the upper-right bar to switch views. This actual quartz-material simulation of Eight Main Highlight shows one viewing condition, not a prediction of physical appearance.

Keep conditions consistent

Use the same material, body color, studio, exposure and viewpoint when comparing two cuts, so differences remain attributable.

Compare frosted and polished finishes

The preview opens in All polished. Select Design surfaces at the upper left to preview frosted finishes saved in the laboratory; unmarked faces remain polished. Keep the material, environment and camera unchanged, then let the image settle before comparing. Switching modes does not change finish annotations, cutting parameters or undo history.

Save each alternative

Material is saved with the document. Keep separate JSON files for A/B alternatives and record viewing conditions. Exiting simulation does not commit unsaved cuts.

Before you continue

Simulation supports design comparison; it does not guarantee physical fire, brightness scores or yield. Material, size, cutting accuracy and viewing environment also affect the real result.

OPTICS AND GEOMETRY · DESIGN JUDGMENT

Four questions for a useful design review

Do not choose only the prettiest perspective image. Examine both alternatives in the same order and explain why you keep or reject each.

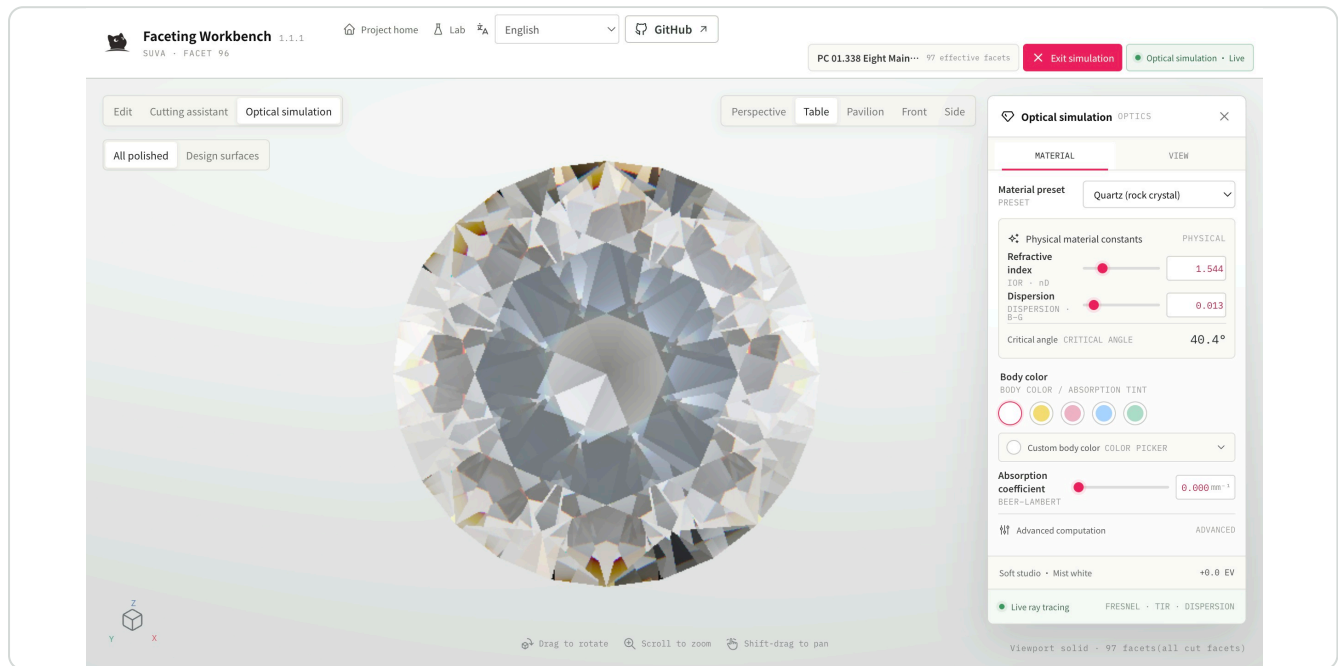


Table view makes outlines and facet groups easier to compare. Rotate slightly to understand changes in light distribution.

Top: does the rhythm work?

Do main and decorative facet proportions support the goal? Is the space around the table intentional or overcrowded?

Front and side: do the proportions fit?

Does the combination of crown height, girdle and pavilion depth suit the intended form and setting direction?

Rotate: can you explain the changes?

With fixed material and exposure, rotate slightly and compare light structure. Avoid hiding large dark areas with overexposure or mistaking studio reflections for facet edges.

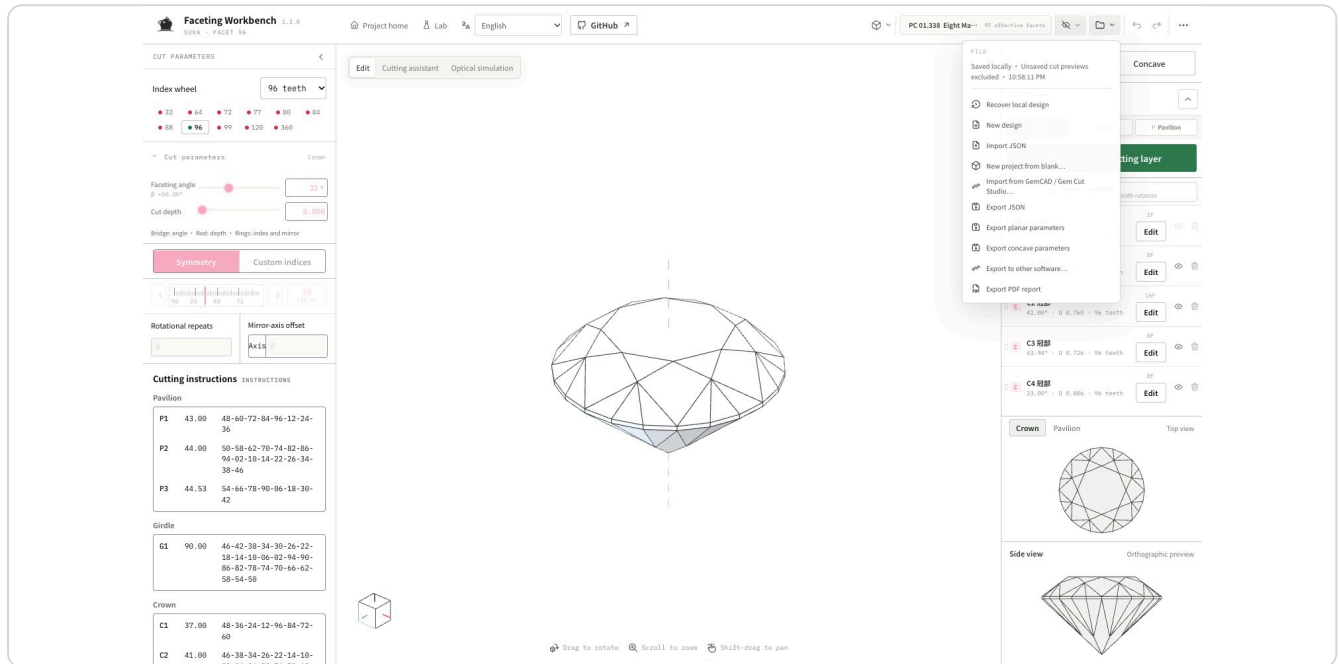
Return to geometry: is the shape clear?

Exit simulation and check intersections, missing facets and remaining rough. An optical image does not replace a geometry check.

FILES · SAVE AND DELIVER

Deliver the design and the ability to keep editing

Provide an editable master file, a report for discussion and a clear design note, alongside any presentation image.



Floating menus close on an outside click or Esc. The File menu offers JSON, PDF and Export to other software..., which opens the format center. Save the CUT first so the export is the design you mean to deliver.

Continue designing: JSON

Preserves stock, planar cuts, concave tools, each tier's wheel, Meet sources, preform intent and optical material. Keep this as the master file. Unsaved previews are excluded.

Read and discuss: PDF

The technical report draws the complete committed solid and lists planar parameters on the selected wheel. Concave tools have a separate appendix. Choose whether to include girdle rows. When the design has frosted faces, it exports as all polished by default, or can mark frosted faces in the views and facet tables. Then check the name, tooth count, units and equipment requirements.

Hand to other software: ASC and GCS

File → Export to other software... opens the format center, where you compare what GemCAD text and Gem Cut Studio keep, simplify or lose. Only final effective planes are exchanged; enabled concave cuts or an imported mesh stock block the export, and the full operations stay in JSON.

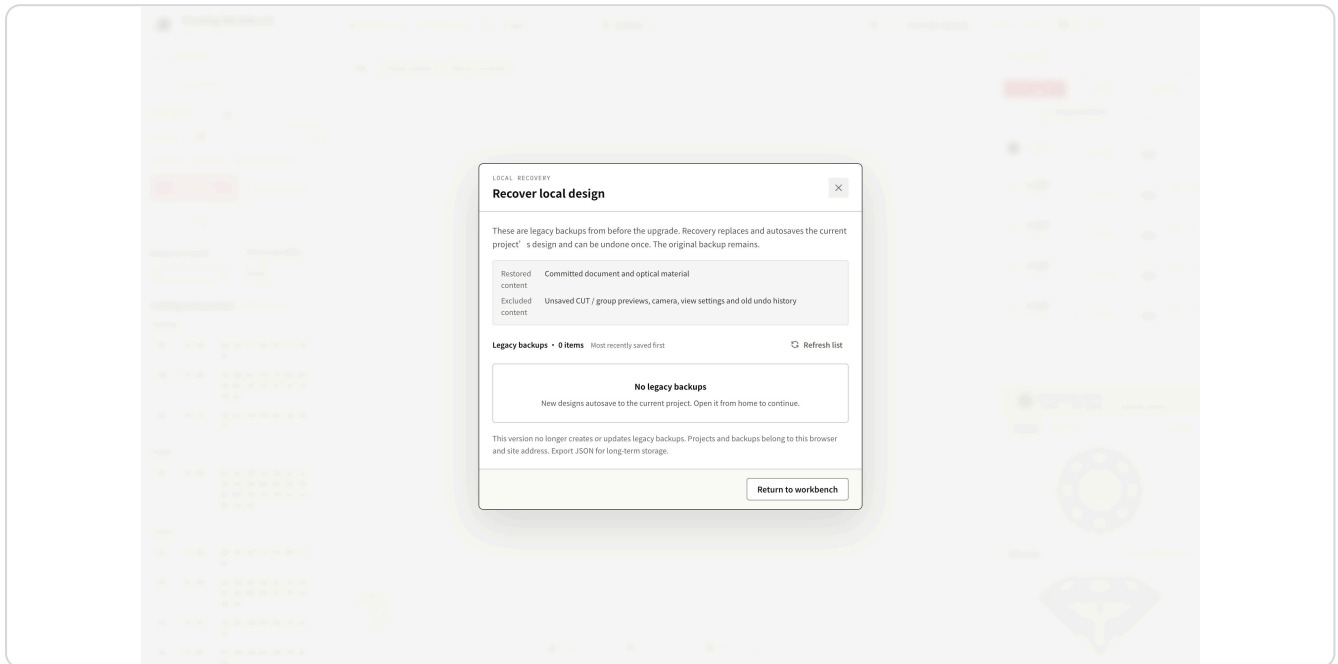
Before you continue

Taking over GemCAD or Gem Cut Studio designs is covered on the last page. Wheels such as 120 and 360, and fractional directions, are kept rather than forced to 96.

PROJECTS · RECOVERY · SHORTCUTS

Save projects and recover older designs

Projects retain the latest committed document and material but do not replace exported JSON archives. Different site addresses or browsers have separate project storage.



File → Recover local design lists legacy backups only. If empty, continue an autosaved project from home.

Project saving and legacy backups

Committed cuts and material save to the current project. Legacy backups migrate once to home and are no longer updated. Manual recovery creates a separate project and preserves both the original project and the backup. Drafts, camera and old history do not survive reload. Concurrent windows detect save conflicts and pause autosave; reload, save as a new project or export JSON to resolve them.

Useful shortcuts

Drag or use arrow keys to turn the near side of the gem in the input direction, consistently in Edit and Optical simulation. Shift-drag pans, scroll zooms, 0 resets. J / Shift+J browse candidates, M locks A, B locks a second point, V toggles vertex picking. Text fields prioritize typing.

When you need an explanation

More tools → Help center. Escape closes help or the active menu without changing the design. If saving fails, retry, export JSON or use Manage local projects to delete unneeded projects and free space. Archive before deleting projects or clearing browser data.

DESIGN REVIEW · DELIVERY CHECKLIST

Complete a design, not just a sequence of clicks

Review the work as a designer: can you discover the controls, understand changes, make trade-offs and hand over the result? Successful interactions are the foundation, not the whole outcome.

State the goal

Use one sentence, for example: "Add lighter four-way decoration while retaining eight crown mains."

Show before and after

Compare original and revised shapes side by side at the same angle. Identify the visible changes, beyond parameter screenshots.

Explain the choice

Describe your preferred outline, open areas or facet rhythm. Record remaining concerns and the next experiment.

Complete delivery

Ensure no CUT is unsaved; address stale sources; check multiple views; export the JSON master and PDF report, with ASC if needed.

Give actionable feedback

Describe "My goal → Where I clicked → What I saw → What I expected", with a screenshot and JSON. Unclear controls and confusing meanings are valid feedback too.

Pause and make a design judgment

Can you explain when group proportions, edge ratios, dual Meet and a custom primary facet helped with your own design problem?

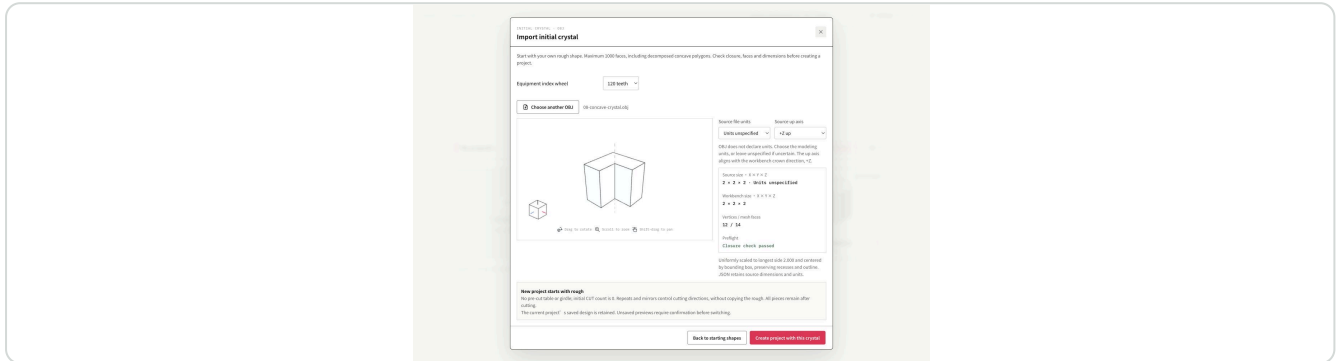
Before you continue

This manual and original exercises are provided by the faceting workbench. Preset authors, sources and third-party font / reference rights remain as documented. The applicable version is printed in the footer.

YOUR CRYSTAL · OBJ IMPORT

Keep the rough's recesses, then plan the cuts

For a starting shape with recesses or an irregular outline, preserve its shape before deciding what to remove. Repeats and mirrors arrange cutting directions; they do not make asymmetric rough symmetric.



Actual preflight of exercise 08's L-shaped crystal: inspect the recess, source dimensions and up axis before creating a separate project.

1

Import a real starting shape

New project → Upload blank, or File → Import initial crystal. The 1,000-face limit includes decomposed faces; failed preflight explains why. Open docs/manual/examples/08-concave-crystal.obj: an original L-shaped exercise measuring $2 \times 2 \times 2$ in unspecified units, +Z up.

2

Inspect shape and proportion

Keep Units unspecified and +Z up. Rotate the preflight model and check the L-shaped notch. For your own OBJ, choose its original units and orientation. The longest side scales uniformly to 2.000 and the bounding box is centered.

3

Start your cutting sequence

Click Create project with this crystal. It starts with no CUTs and no automatic table or girdle. Add a cut below the CUT STACK region tabs; start with one repeat and compare the original recess with the new facet.

4

Keep a recoverable design

All pieces remain if a cut separates the solid. Clear cuts restores the original rough. JSON saves the rough and operations; crystal projects do not support ASC export, as preflight explains. Canceling import preserves the old project; switching asks about unsaved previews.

Pause and make a design judgment

Compare before and after in the same top and front views: did the new plane preserve the recess you wanted? Which repeated directions actually intersected the rough?

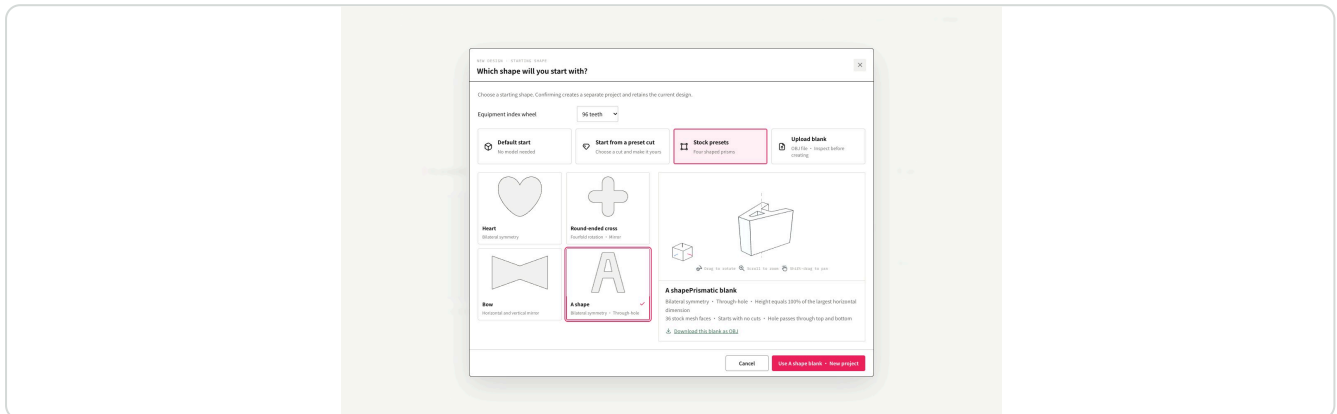
Before you continue

This exercise teaches the relationship between rough and cutting direction, not crystal measurement or a production recipe. If preflight fails, repair closure and face connectivity in a modeler, then re-export OBJ.

STOCK PRESETS · ORIGINAL OUTLINES

Design from a shaped blank

Start directly with a heart, round-ended cross, bow or an A shape with a through-hole, without preparing a model.



Actual starting-shape chooser. Cross-section cards identify the outline; rotate the solid preview to inspect thickness and holes.

1

Choose a design starting point

New project → Stock presets → A shape. All four blanks have height equal to 100% of the largest horizontal dimension. A has bilateral symmetry and a through-hole; heart is bilateral, cross has fourfold rotational and mirror symmetry, bow mirrors horizontally and vertically.

2

Inspect before creating

Inspect the solid, then choose Use A-shaped blank · New project. It starts with zero CUTs; add a crown cut on the right. Canceling or going back preserves the original design.

3

Compare before and after cutting

Try one cut and adjust depth while observing the A's hole and legs. Save and undo to compare outline retention at the same angle. Symmetric rough does not automatically mirror cutting instructions.

4

Test your import workflow

Download the selected blank as OBJ and reimport through Upload blank. Keep units unspecified and +Z up; check the 100% height and through-hole. The default starting option still includes its table and girdle.

Pause and make a design judgment

Do the preset's recesses, holes and thickness suit your starting point in top and side views? Does one cut remove only what you intended?

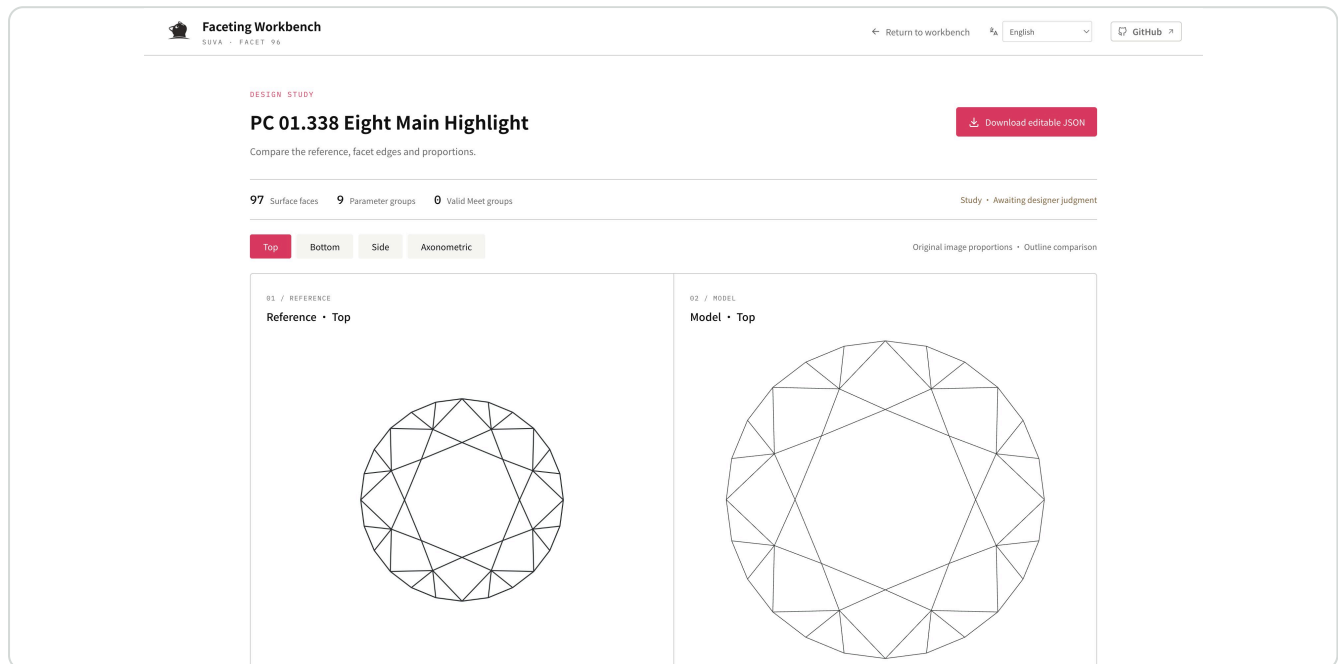
Before you continue

OBJ downloads in stock-presets/ use the same outlines as the built-in presets. A blank is a starting shape, not a finished gemstone cut.

CUT STUDY · CODEX ASSISTANCE

Turn a reference into an editable design

Bring a reference image and design intent. State the outline, table and girdle thickness to retain, then compare actual models and resolve unclear connections step by step.



Eight Main Highlight study page: the left reference is its technical top view; the right uses the same preset JSON. This demonstrates comparison workflow, not photographic reconstruction accuracy.

1

Tell Codex your goal

Use facet-parametric-design in the workbench project with an image you have permission to use. Ask it to separate known details from inferences and deliver editable JSON with real-view comparisons. The workbench can edit and import independently without Codex.

2

Compare under the same conditions

Open the generated study page and inspect top, bottom, side and axonometric views. Missing independent references are disclosed. Images must not be stretched to manufacture a match.

3

Keep the study and refine it

Download editable JSON and import it through the file menu in a new project. Adjust one group's angle or depth and inspect facet width and girdle thickness. Save the accepted variation and compare from the same angle.

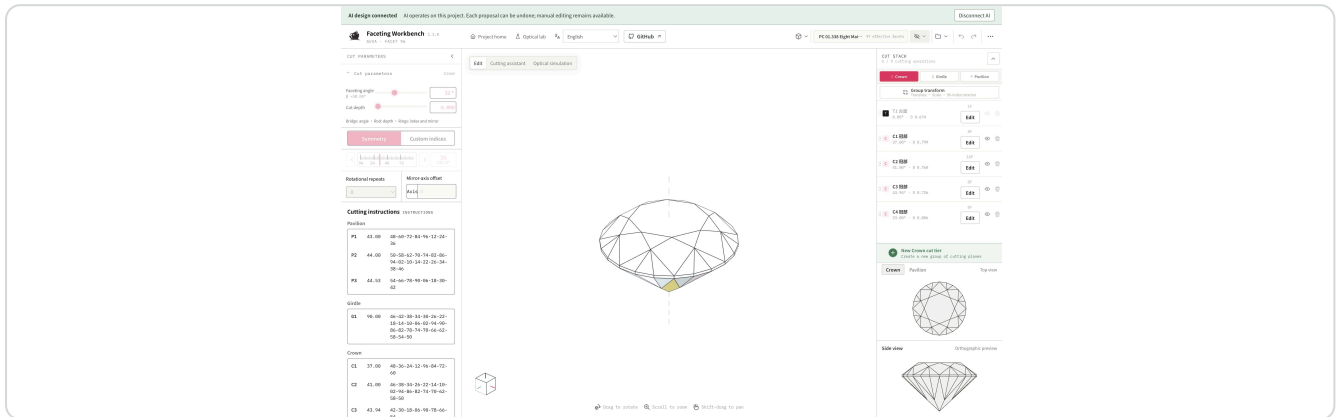
Pause and make a design judgment

Which connection or proportion did this version resolve? Which areas still depend on inference and need a clearer reference or your judgment?

OPTIONAL LOCAL AI · CONVERSATIONAL DESIGN

Combine conversation and manual editing

Compare alternatives in conversation, then refine familiar parameters manually. Both use the same CUTs and undo history. The manual workbench requires neither Codex nor MCP.



Actual connected workbench: Eight Main Highlight, 97 effective facets. The following steps share one design between conversation and manual editing.

- Open the connected workbench**
 Ask an MCP-capable client to open the local workbench and follow its returned link. The top bar shows AI design connected. Ask the conversation to confirm the project name, then describe the outline to keep and the facets to change. Ordinary web use needs no connection.
- Compare before applying**
 Request real top, bottom, side and 3D previews and an explanation of affected facets. After applying, inspect the actual CUT STACK tiers; Undo reverts the change in one step. Save or discard a manual edit before continuing through conversation.
- Refine manually and archive**
 Edit the target tier, adjust angle or depth, compare from the same view and save. Request editable JSON in conversation or export it from File. Use JSON as a reliable transfer between browsers or local ports.
- Return to manual design at any time**
 Click Disconnect AI at the top. The project, history and parameter controls remain usable. Users without AI can create, import, edit, save and export in the standalone static workbench.

Pause and make a design judgment

At the same top and side views, did the crown change retain the intended outline and meetings? Which steps suit conversational exploration, and which need your manual judgment?

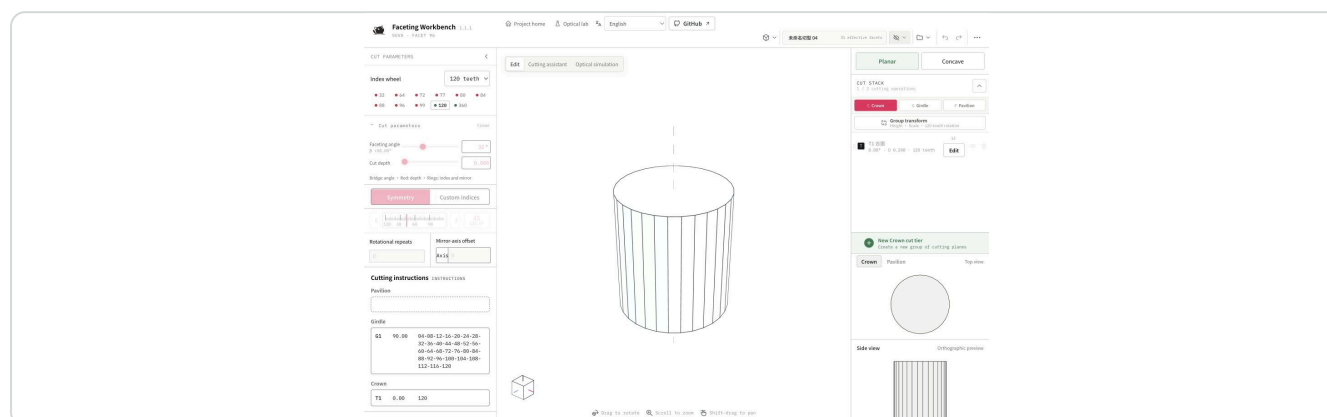
Before you continue

This page checks collaboration workflow, not cutting or optical gains. See docs/mcp/README.md for MCP installation and development. Codex and other local MCP clients are supported.

Equipment wheel · Green and red

Choose the equipment wheel before designing

Choose the wheel supported by your equipment at project creation. Planar cuts and the girdle share it; stock and concave cutters remain independent shapes.



The default 120-wheel project has a 30-fold girdle. Compact green and red dots show compatibility.

1 Start with a defined project

Home → New project. Choose a 120 wheel and use the default starting shape. Keep the perspective and side views unchanged.

2 Check your wheel

The dot beside 120 is green. Girdle instructions use 120 teeth, without a 32-fold girdle inherited from a 96 wheel.

3 Compare wheel changes

Switch to 96. The shape stays intact, all planar readings convert to 96 teeth, and incompatible directions produce a red dot.

4 Return to your equipment

Undo the wheel change or select 120 again. Existing fractional directions are never silently rounded.

Pause and make a design judgment

Does the outline stay the same after switching wheels? Can you see compatibility at a glance?

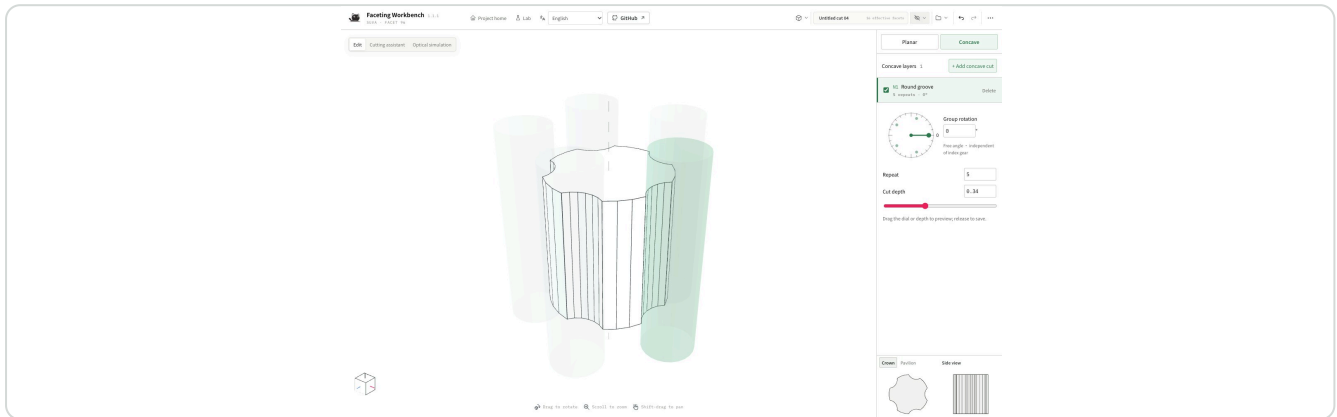
Before you continue

Dots check planar directions only, excluding stock and concave tools. Exercise 09 provides an additional legacy design for exact conversion checks.

CONCAVE LAYERS · REPEAT, ROTATE & DEPTH

Add five grooves with one cutter

Choose a cutter and see how it changes the outline. No coordinates, axes or long parameter forms are needed.



The same 120-index default project, with a round groove added in the right Concave panel: five repeats, fixed-frame depth 0.34.

1 Add a cutter

Continue the 120-index project. On the right choose Concave, then Add concave cut → Round groove. Translucent tools show placement; five grooves appear in the solid.

2 Adjust the two controls

Select the Flute and drag depth from 0.34 to 0.50. While still holding the mouse, observe the live grooves and orthographic views; release to save.

3 Compare repetition and shape

Change the concave repeat count from 5 to 6, then rotate the group to 17.5°. Keep the viewing angle fixed to compare groove placement. Enabling or disabling a tool changes the saved design; use the concave visibility button in the planar panel for a temporary comparison.

4 Restore your preferred design

Undo rotation, repeat count and depth to return to five repeats, 0° and depth 0.34. In the planar panel, hide concave cuts to inspect the planar design, then show them to compare the combined result. This does not change the saved file. Each drag is one undo step. Triangular grooves also expose tip angle, width and length; angle and width changes retain the cutting depth, while length follows the tool axis.

Pause and make a design judgment

Do deeper or more numerous grooves preserve the girdle width and edges you want? Does undo restore the original fivefold shape?

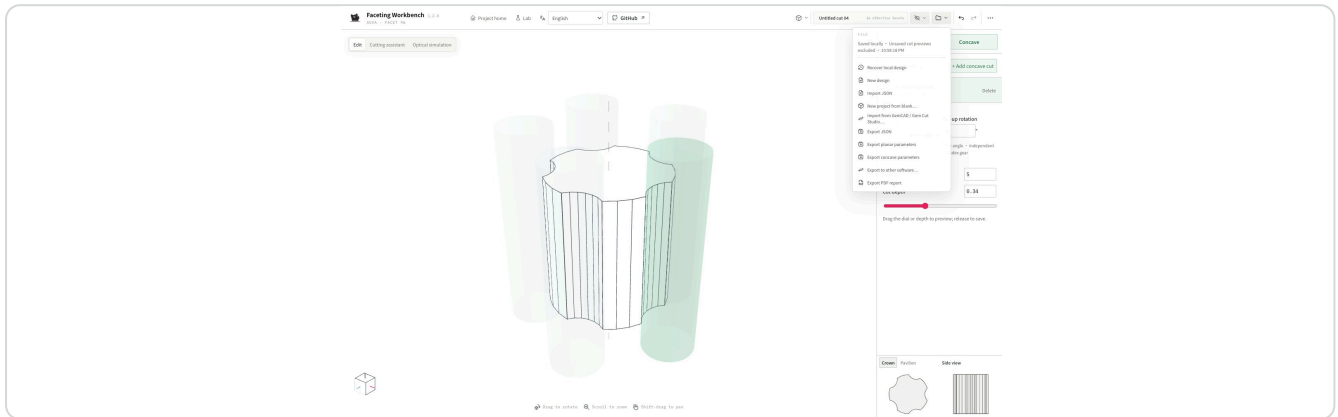
Before you continue

V groove uses an ideal 90° edged wheel. A thick blank may retain its top and bottom edges. Changes can be undone; the simulation does not guarantee machining or polishing results.

Saving designs · Reusing parameters

Save and export from the File menu

All exports are in the top File menu. The left sidebar holds planar parameters; the blank is fixed at creation. Switch between planar and concave layers on the right.



The File menu offers JSON, planar parameters, concave parameters, PDF, and import/export through the format center; a solid stock also allows exporting stock parameters.

1 Save the full design

In the five-groove project, open File and export JSON. It preserves the wheel, stock, planar cuts and concave cutters.

2 Check the wheel

Before exporting JSON or PDF, check the selected and compatible wheels. Never read 120-wheel indices directly on a 96 wheel; red means whole teeth do not match.

3 Choose the appropriate format

Stock and planar parameters are in the same menu; PDF is for reading the report. A complete design with enabled concave cuts cannot convert to ASC or GCS, and the format center explains why.

4 Check the restored shape

Import the complete JSON as a new project and compare top and side views. The wheel, planar cuts and five grooves should match; the original project remains.

Pause and make a design judgment

Can you find every export in one place? Does the report wheel match the equipment you intend to use?

Before you continue

Keep complete JSON for important projects: planar parameters are required, stock and round tools are optional. Unspecified indexing means 96; compatibility is recalculated from actual directions.

Format center · See the differences before converting

Take over GemCAD and Gem Cut Studio designs

Old designs need not be redrawn. The format center reads GemCAD (.asc, .gem) and Gem Cut Studio (.gcs) and can hand your design back to them, listing what is kept and what is lost before every conversion.

2 Choose a destination

Open in workbench
Opens as a separate project; the current project is unchanged

Fully kept

Everything in this design can be written

GemCAD text .asc
GemCAD 5, Gem Cut Studio, online design libraries

2 lost

Not written: Frosted facets, Gem Cut Studio material and color

Project for this app .json
Save as a complete project file without opening

Fully kept

Everything in this design can be written

Not written 2

Frosted facets
1 facets
written as ordinary polished facets

Gem Cut Studio material and color
set

Fully kept 3

Facet shape
16 tiers · 57 facets

Tier names and cutting notes
16 tiers

Refractive index
1.54

Read back and checked: same shape

Accept differences and export Format-center-desktop-regression.asc →

A square emerald saved by Gem Cut Studio 1.1 (with one frosted face), with GemCAD text selected: the card and report state that frosted facets and the Gem Cut Studio material are not written, everything else is kept, and the exported file was read back and checked.

1 Open the format center

Project home → Format center; or in the editor, File → Import from GemCAD / Gem Cut Studio....

2 Choose a source

Drop an .asc, .gem or .gcs file and check the preview, wheel, tier / facet counts and frosted facets. Reading never changes the original file or the current project.

3 Compare destinations

Select Open in workbench, GemCAD text and Project for this app in turn, and read each card's result and the Not written / Simplified / Fully kept lists below.

4 Decide and continue

Open in workbench creates a separate project. When an export has differences the button reads Accept differences and export, and one click completes it; the export is read back to check the shape.

Pause and make a design judgment

Does the information this conversion drops matter for what you are handing over? Keep a JSON as the complete master if you will keep editing.

Before you continue

GemCAD .gem is read only. Designs without a single table convert directly between ASC and GCS but cannot open in the workbench. Gem Cut Studio index directions are calibrated on real version 1.1 saves and were checked in Gem Cut Studio with a twisted design.